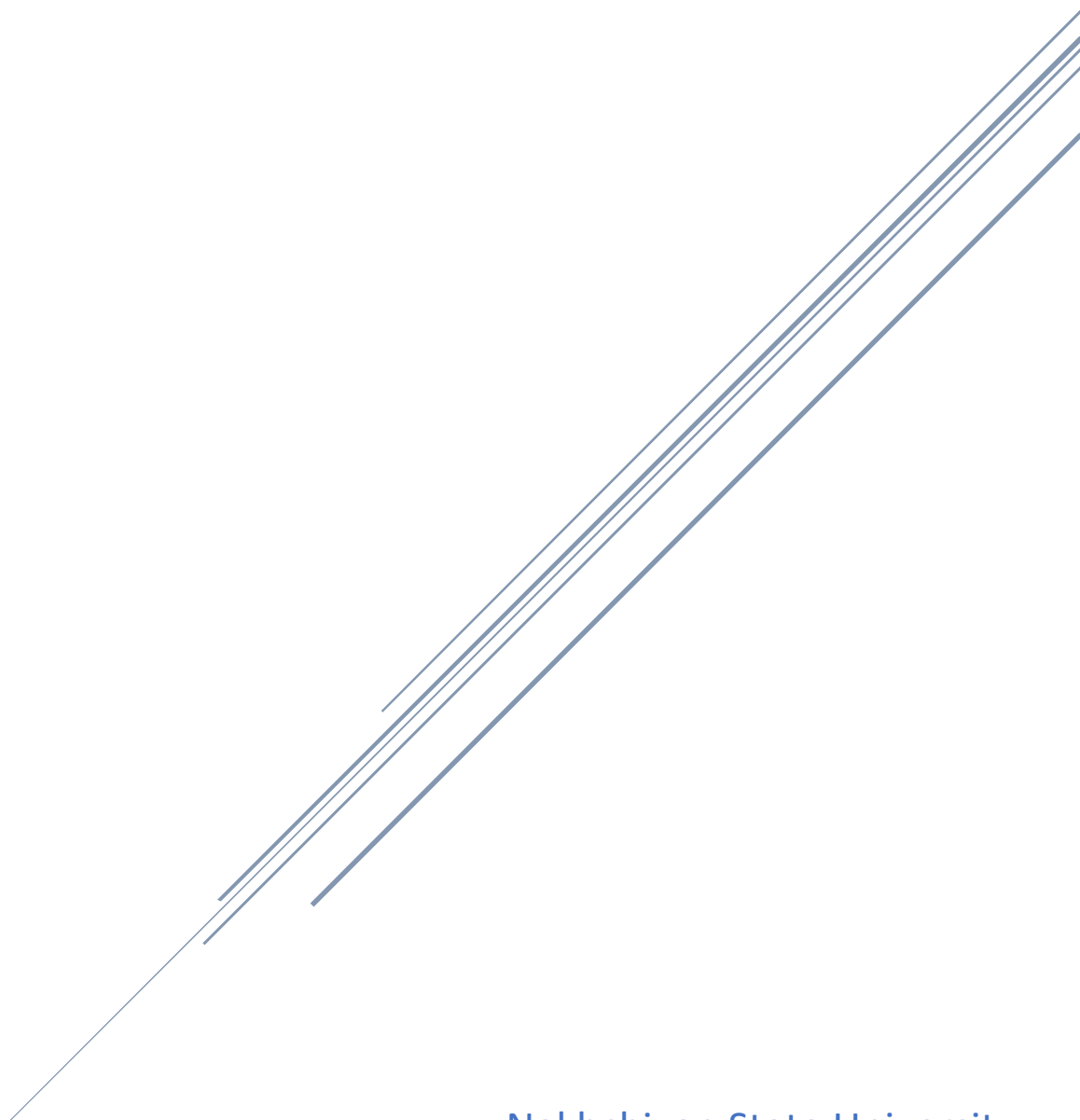


CONNECT WITH ENGLISH

A1-A2 SPEAKING HANDBOOK

Unlocking Conversations, One Word at a Time.



Nakhchivan State University
Hasan Alisoy

Dear Esteemed Colleague and English Language Educators,

I am delighted to present my newest publication, "Connect with English: A1-A2 Speaking Handbook." Tailored to meet the unique needs of first-year Azerbaijani university students, this handbook serves as an innovative resource in the field of English language teaching. Designed to cover the A1 to A2 levels, 35-lesson curriculum to facilitate and enrich English speaking skills.

Drawing upon my extensive experience as a lecturer in the ELT and Translation Faculty at Nakhchivan State University, I have identified critical gaps in our current teaching methodologies. This handbook aims to address these shortcomings by offering a well-structured yet flexible guide that enables students to confidently express themselves in English. Each lesson is replete with carefully curated activities designed to hone linguistic capabilities while broadening students' cultural understanding.

From rudimentary topics like greetings and introductions to complex subjects such as globalization and multiculturalism, this handbook offers a graduated learning experience that sustains student engagement. A variety of teaching tools, including role-play scenarios, discussion prompts, and self-reflective exercises, are integrated to make the learning journey interactive and fulfilling. Vocabulary and key phrases have been meticulously chosen to adhere to A2 level requirements, thus ensuring both relevance and challenge.

I am confident that "Connect with English: A1-A2 Speaking Handbook" will serve as an invaluable asset for educators committed to advancing the English language proficiency of their students. The book can either stand alone as a complete course or be seamlessly incorporated into existing curricular frameworks.

Thank you for considering this publication for your pedagogical needs. I am enthusiastic about the potential impact it will have on both educators and students and am eager to receive your valuable feedback.

With warmest regards,

Hasan Alisoy

Lesson 1: Introductions and Greetings

New Words and Definitions:

1. Introduction: The act of making someone known by name to another in person, often formally.
2. Greetings: Something that is said or done to show respect or friendship when you meet someone.
3. Name: A word or set of words by which a person is known.
4. Age: The number of years someone has lived or something has existed.
5. Birthplace: The place where someone was born.
6. Nationality: The status of belonging to a particular nation by origin, birth, or naturalization.
7. Origin: The place where something comes from or starts at, or the cause of something.
8. Hometown: The town or city that a person is from, especially the place where they were born and grew up.
9. Hello: Used as a greeting or to begin a conversation.
10. Nice to meet you: A polite phrase used when being introduced to someone for the first time.
11. Goodbye: Used when someone leaves.

Questions and Sample Answers:

1. Q: What's your name?
A: My name is Leyla.
2. Q: How old are you?
A: I'm 18 years old.
3. Q: Where were you born?
A: I was born in Ganja, Azerbaijan.
4. Q: What's your nationality?

A: I'm Azerbaijani.

5. Q: Where's your hometown?

A: My hometown is Ganja, which is a city in Azerbaijan.

6. Q: How do you greet people in your culture?

A: We usually say "Salam" which means "Hello" in Azerbaijani.

7. Q: What do you say to greet someone in English?

A: In English, I usually say "Hello" or "Hi".

8. Q: What do you say when you meet someone for the first time?

A: I usually say "Nice to meet you."

9. Q: How do you introduce yourself to someone in English?

A: I say "Hello, my name is Leyla. I'm from Azerbaijan."

10. Q: What do you say when you're leaving?

A: I usually say "Goodbye" or "See you later."

11. Q: Can you introduce a friend in English?

A: Yes, I can say "This is my friend, Mehmet. He's also from Ganja."

12. Q: How would you introduce your family members?

A: I would say, "These are my parents, Ali and Fatima, and this is my younger brother, Elvin."

13. Q: How do you ask someone their name in English?

A: I would ask, "What's your name?"

14. Q: How do you ask about someone's age in English?

A: I would ask, "How old are you?"

15. Q: How do you ask about someone's birthplace?

A: I would ask, "Where were you born?"

16. Q: How do you inquire about someone's nationality in English?

A: I would ask, "What's your nationality?"

17. Q: How do you ask about someone's hometown?

A: I would ask, "Where's your hometown?"

18. Q: How do you greet someone in the morning?

A: I would say, "Good morning."

19. Q: How do you greet someone in the evening?

A: I would say, "Good evening."

20. Q: How would you introduce your hometown to a foreign friend?

A: I would say, "I come from Ganja, a beautiful city in Azerbaijan known for its rich history and culture."

Lesson 2: Family

New Words and Definitions:

1. Family: A group of people who are related to each other.
2. Parents: A mother or a father.
3. Siblings: Brothers or sisters.
4. Grandparents: The parents of one's parents.
5. Cousins: The children of one's aunt or uncle.
6. Relatives: Members of your family.
7. Tradition: A specific practice of long-standing.
8. Celebration: The act of marking one's pleasure at an important event or occasion by engaging in enjoyable activities.
9. Relationship: The way in which two or more people are connected.
10. Ancestors: A person, typically one more remote than a grandparent, from whom one is descended.
11. Culture: The ideas, customs, and social behavior of a particular people or society.
12. Close-knit: Having strong relationships with each other and taking a close interest in each other's activities and concerns.
13. Bond: A connection between individuals or groups based on shared feelings, interests, or experiences.
14. Respect: A feeling of deep admiration for someone elicited by their abilities, qualities, or achievements.
15. Affection: A gentle feeling of fondness or liking.

Questions and Sample Answers:

1. Q: Can you describe your family?

A: My family is small and close-knit. It consists of my parents, my younger brother, and me.

2. Q: How many siblings do you have?

A: I have one younger brother.

3. Q: Can you describe your parents?

A: My mother is a teacher and she's very kind. My father is a doctor and he's hardworking.

4. Q: What are your grandparents like?

A: My grandparents are retired. They are caring, wise, and enjoy telling stories about our ancestors.

5. Q: Do you have any cousins?

A: Yes, I have a few cousins. We enjoy spending holidays together.

6. Q: How often do you see your relatives?

A: We usually meet during special occasions and traditional celebrations.

7. Q: What's your favorite family tradition?

A: My favorite family tradition is gathering for a large meal during the New Year celebration.

8. Q: How important is family to you?

A: Family is very important to me. We share a strong bond and support each other.

9. Q: How do you show respect to your elders?

A: We show respect to our elders by listening to their advice and helping them when needed.

10. Q: How do you celebrate birthdays in your family?

A: We usually have a small party at home. We sing, dance, and share a special meal.

11. Q: Can you describe the relationship you have with your siblings?

A: I have a good relationship with my younger brother. We play games and study together.

12. Q: What's your role in the family?

A: As the eldest child, I help my parents by taking care of my younger brother.

13. Q: What family traditions do you want to pass on?

A: I would like to pass on the tradition of family gatherings during holidays.

14. Q: How do you express affection in your family?

A: We express affection by spending quality time together, helping each other, and saying words of encouragement.

15. Q: Do you have any family traditions related to education?

A: Yes, it's a family tradition to celebrate academic achievements and we encourage each other to pursue education.

16. Q: How do you celebrate traditional holidays with your family?

A: We prepare traditional dishes, visit relatives, and share gifts.

17. Q: Can you tell us about your family's cultural background?

A: My family is Azerbaijani and we are proud of our rich history, language, and traditions.

18. Q: What lessons have you learned from your family?

A: I've learned the importance of respect, hard work, and staying true to our cultural values.

19. Q: How do your family support your studies?

A: My family supports my studies by providing a peaceful study environment and motivating me.

20. Q: Can you share a memorable family event?

A: One memorable event was our last summer vacation when we traveled to the Caspian Sea. We had a great time together.

Lesson 3: Hobbies and Interests

New Words and Definitions:

1. Hobbies: Activities done regularly in one's leisure time for pleasure.
2. Interests: Things that someone likes, wants to know about, or is involved in.
3. Enjoy: To get pleasure from something.
4. Leisure: Time spent in or free for relaxation or enjoyment.
5. Photography: The art or practice of taking and processing photographs.
6. Reading: The action or skill of absorbing written or printed matter silently or aloud.
7. Sports: Activities involving physical exertion and skill in which an individual or team competes against another for entertainment.
8. Gardening: The activity of tending and cultivating a garden.
9. Painting: The action or skill of using paint to depict a scene, object, or form.
10. Music: Vocal or instrumental sounds combined in such a way as to produce beauty of form, harmony, and expression of emotion.
11. Collecting: The action or hobby of accumulating things of a particular kind as a hobby.
12. Cooking: The practice or skill of preparing food by combining, mixing, and heating ingredients.
13. Dancing: The action of moving rhythmically to music, typically following a set sequence of steps.
14. Hiking: The activity of going for long walks, especially across country.
15. Gaming: The action or practice of playing video games.
16. Baking: The process of cooking food by dry heat without direct exposure to a flame, typically in an oven.

Questions and Sample Answers:

1. Q: What are your hobbies?

A: My hobbies include reading, playing football, and cooking.

2. Q: Why do you enjoy these hobbies?

A: I enjoy reading because it broadens my knowledge. Playing football keeps me fit and cooking allows me to be creative.

3. Q: How much time do you spend on your hobbies?

A: I spend a few hours on my hobbies each day, depending on my schedule.

4. Q: Do you have any hobbies that you share with your friends or family?

A: Yes, my family and I enjoy hiking on weekends.

5. Q: Are there any hobbies you'd like to try?

A: I would like to try photography. It seems interesting to capture moments.

6. Q: Do you prefer outdoor or indoor hobbies?

A: I prefer outdoor hobbies because I enjoy being in nature.

7. Q: What hobbies did you have when you were younger?

A: When I was younger, I enjoyed painting and collecting stamps.

8. Q: Have your hobbies changed over time? If so, how?

A: Yes, I used to enjoy painting, but now I'm more interested in sports.

9. Q: Can you recommend a hobby to a friend?

A: I would recommend reading. It's a good way to relax and learn new things.

10. Q: Do any of your hobbies relate to your studies or future career?

A: Yes, reading helps me in my studies and cooking could be useful if I decide to become a chef.

11. Q: What's the most unusual hobby you've heard of?

A: The most unusual hobby I've heard of is storm chasing.

12. Q: Do you enjoy watching or participating in sports?

A: I enjoy both, but I prefer participating because it's more active and fun.

13. Q: What do you learn from your hobbies?

A: My hobbies teach me patience, discipline, and creativity.

14. Q: Do you like to collect anything?

A: Yes, I like to collect postcards from different countries.

15. Q: How do your hobbies make you feel?

A: My hobbies make me feel relaxed and happy.

16. Q: Do you like to dance?

A: Yes, I enjoy dancing. It's a fun way to express myself and stay fit.

17. Q: Do you play any musical instruments?

A: I play the guitar. I find it enjoyable and soothing.

18. Q: Do you like baking or cooking more?

A: I enjoy cooking more because there's a wider variety of dishes I can make.

19. Q: Have you ever tried any extreme sports or hobbies?

A: No, I haven't tried any extreme sports, but I'd like to try skydiving one day.

20. Q: What is one hobby you think everyone should try?

A: I think everyone should try gardening. It's a peaceful hobby and you can grow your own food.

The vocabulary in this lesson is useful for discussing hobbies and interests, and the questions and answers provide a context for the application of this vocabulary. The learner is encouraged to personalize the responses to make them more relevant and meaningful.

Lesson 4: Daily Routine

New Words and Definitions:

1. Routine: A sequence of actions regularly followed.
2. Morning: The period of time between sunrise and noon.
3. Afternoon: The time from noon or lunchtime to evening.
4. Evening: The period of time at the end of the day, usually from about 6 p.m. to bedtime.
5. Night: The period of darkness between sunset and sunrise.
6. Breakfast: A meal eaten in the morning, the first of the day.
7. Lunch: A meal eaten in the middle of the day.
8. Dinner: The main meal of the day, taken either around midday or in the evening.
9. Exercise: Activity requiring physical effort, carried out to sustain or improve health and fitness.
10. Work: Mental or physical activity as a means of earning income; employment.
11. Study: The devotion of time and attention to acquiring knowledge on an academic subject.
12. Relax: Make or become less tense or anxious.
13. Sleep: A condition of body and mind such as that which typically recurs for several hours every night, in which the nervous system is inactive, the eyes closed, the postural muscles relaxed, and consciousness practically suspended.
14. Time management: The ability to use one's time effectively or productively.
15. Schedule: A plan for carrying out a process or procedure, giving lists of intended events and times.
16. Habit: A settled or regular tendency or practice.
17. Commute: Travel some distance between one's home and place of work on a regular basis.
18. Leisure: Free time.
19. Chores: A routine task, especially a household one.
20. Errands: A short journey undertaken in order to deliver or collect something.

Questions and Sample Answers:

1. Q: Can you describe your daily routine?

A: I wake up early, have breakfast, and then go to university. After my classes, I have lunch, do my homework, and then I have some free time to relax.

2. Q: What's the first thing you do in the morning?

A: The first thing I do in the morning is brush my teeth.

3. Q: What do you do during your lunch break?

A: During my lunch break, I usually eat and chat with my friends.

4. Q: What do you usually do in the evening?

A: In the evening, I usually have dinner with my family, watch some TV, and then read a book before going to sleep.

5. Q: How much sleep do you usually get each night?

A: I usually get about eight hours of sleep each night.

6. Q: What activities do you do for relaxation?

A: For relaxation, I enjoy reading, listening to music, and going for a walk.

7. Q: How do you manage your time effectively?

A: I manage my time by making a schedule and prioritizing my tasks.

8. Q: Do you have a set schedule, or is each day different?

A: My weekdays are usually the same because of my university schedule, but my weekends are different.

9. Q: What's your favorite part of the day?

A: My favorite part of the day is the evening when I can relax and spend time with my family.

10. Q: Do you have any habits that help you stay organized?

A: Yes, I always make a to-do list for the next day before going to bed.

11. Q: Do you do any physical exercise during the day?

A: Yes, I usually do some exercises in the morning to keep myself fit.

12. Q: How do you get to university?

A: I usually take the bus to university.

13. Q: How do you usually spend your weekends?

A: On weekends, I like to relax, meet with friends, and sometimes go on short trips.

14. Q: Do you have any chores at home?

A: Yes, I help with cleaning and sometimes cook dinner.

15. Q: How many hours do you study each day?

A: I usually study for about three to four hours each day.

16. Q: Do you take breaks while studying?

A: Yes, I believe it's important to take short breaks for better concentration.

17. Q: Do you prefer to study in the morning or at night?

A: I prefer to study in the morning when my mind is fresh.

18. Q: Do you do any errands during the day?

A: Yes, sometimes I do errands like grocery shopping or paying bills.

19. Q: How do you prepare for the next day?

A: I prepare by reviewing my schedule, packing my bag, and setting my alarm.

20. Q: What is your bedtime routine?

A: My bedtime routine involves brushing my teeth, reading a bit, and then going to sleep.

Lesson 5: School and University Life

New Words and Definitions:

1. University: An educational institution designed for instruction, examination, or both, of students in many branches of advanced learning.
2. Subjects: Branches of knowledge studied or taught in a school, college, or university.
3. Classroom: A room in a school where lessons take place.
4. Facilities: The buildings, equipment, and services provided for a particular purpose.
5. Educational Goals: Targets set by students for academic progress and personal development.
6. Lecture: An educational talk to an audience, especially to students in a university.
7. Seminar: A conference or other meeting for discussion or training.
8. Homework: Schoolwork that a student is required to do at home.
9. Exams: A formal test of a person's knowledge or proficiency in a particular subject or skill.
10. Major: The main subject or course of study in which a student at a college or university specializes.
11. Minor: A secondary field of study in undergraduate education.
12. Study group: A group of people who meet regularly to study the same subject.
13. Research: The systematic investigation into and study of materials and sources in order to establish facts and reach new conclusions.
14. Thesis: A long essay or dissertation involving personal research, written by a candidate for a university degree.
15. Library: A building or room containing collections of books, periodicals, and sometimes films and recorded music for people to read, borrow, or refer to.
16. Dormitory: A large bedroom for a number of people in a school or institution.
17. Cafeteria: A restaurant in which customers serve themselves from a counter and pay before eating.

18. Extracurricular activities: Non-academic activities, such as sports or clubs, that take place in a school or university.

19. Tuition: A sum of money charged for teaching or instruction by a school, college, or university.

20. Scholarships: Grants or payments made to support a student's education, awarded on the basis of academic or other achievements.

Questions and Sample Answers:

1. Q: What university do you attend?

A: I attend the University of Azerbaijan.

2. Q: What is your major?

A: My major is English Literature.

3. Q: Why did you choose this major?

A: I chose this major because I love reading and analyzing texts, and I'm interested in understanding different cultures through literature.

4. Q: Do you have a minor? If yes, what is it?

A: Yes, my minor is History. I believe that understanding the past helps us to understand the present.

5. Q: What subjects are you studying this semester?

A: This semester, I'm studying Shakespearean literature, postcolonial theory, and European history.

6. Q: How do you prepare for exams?

A: I prepare for exams by reviewing my notes, doing practice questions, and participating in study groups.

7. Q: Do you do any research? If yes, what is it about?

A: Yes, I'm currently working on a research project about the representation of women in 19th-century literature.

8. Q: What facilities do you use most at your university?

A: I often use the library for studying and research, and I also spend a lot of time in the English department's seminar room.

9. Q: Do you live in a dormitory or off-campus?

A: I live in a dormitory on campus. It's convenient and a great way to meet other students.

10. Q: What's the food like in the cafeteria?

A: The food in the cafeteria is quite varied, with options for different dietary preferences.

11. Q: Are you a member of any clubs or organizations?

A: Yes, I'm a member of the university's drama club and the literature society.

12. Q: Do you have a scholarship?

A: Yes, I was fortunate to receive a scholarship based on my high school grades.

13. Q: What are your educational goals?

A: My main educational goal is to gain a deep understanding of my field and develop my critical thinking skills. I also aim to maintain a high GPA.

14. Q: How do you manage your time between classes, homework, and leisure activities?

A: I use a planner to schedule my tasks and make sure I have a balance between academic work and leisure activities.

15. Q: Do you prefer lectures or seminars?

A: I prefer seminars because they are more interactive and allow for in-depth discussions.

16. Q: How much time do you spend studying each day?

A: I usually spend around four to five hours studying each day.

17. Q: How does the education system in your country work?

A: In Azerbaijan, after completing high school, students can either go to vocational schools or universities. Universities offer bachelor's, master's, and doctoral degrees.

18. Q: Have you ever studied abroad?

A: No, I haven't had the chance to study abroad yet, but it's something I'd like to do in the future.

19. Q: How do you handle stress during exam periods?

A: I handle stress by making sure I start studying well in advance, taking regular breaks, and doing some physical exercise.

20. Q: What do you like the most about your university life?

A: What I like most about university life is the opportunity to learn about things I'm passionate about and meet people from diverse backgrounds.

Lesson 6: Describing People and Characters

New Words and Definitions:

1. Physical Appearance: The outward aesthetic or visible look of a person.
2. Personality: The combination of characteristics or qualities that form an individual's distinctive character.
3. Traits: Distinguishing qualities or characteristics of a person.
4. Celebrity: A famous person, typically successful in entertainment or sports.
5. Fictional Characters: Imaginary persons in a work of fiction.
6. Adjectives: A word naming an attribute of a noun, describing a person, place, or thing.
7. Hair: The natural fine, thread-like strands growing from the skin of humans.
8. Eyes: The organ of sight in humans and animals.
9. Height: The measurement of someone from head to foot.
10. Build: The physique of a person.
11. Outfit: A set of clothes worn together, usually for a specific occasion.
12. Friendly: Kind and pleasant.
13. Intelligent: Having or showing intelligence, especially of a high level.
14. Funny: Causing laughter or amusement.
15. Brave: Ready to face and endure danger or pain; showing courage.
16. Motivated: Providing with a reason to act in a certain way.
17. Ambitious: Having a strong desire and determination to succeed.
18. Shy: Being reserved or having or showing nervousness or timidity in the company of others.
19. Serious: Solemn or thoughtful in character or manner.
20. Imaginative: Having or showing creativity or inventiveness.

Questions and Sample Answers:

1. Q: Can you describe your best friend's physical appearance?

A: My best friend is tall and has a slim build. He has short, curly black hair and deep brown eyes.

2. Q: What is your best friend's personality like?

A: My best friend is very friendly and funny. She's also quite intelligent and always curious about new things.

3. Q: Can you describe your favorite celebrity?

A: My favorite celebrity is Tom Hanks. He's of average height, with brown hair and blue eyes. He often wears formal attire at public events.

4. Q: What do you admire about your favorite celebrity's personality?

A: I admire his humility despite his fame, his sense of humor, and his dedication to his craft.

5. Q: Can you describe a character from your favorite book or movie?

A: Hermione Granger from the Harry Potter series is a young girl with bushy brown hair and brown eyes. She's known for her intelligence and bravery.

6. Q: Why do you like this character?

A: I like Hermione because she's smart, brave, and loyal. She stands up for what she believes in and values her friendships.

7. Q: How would you describe your own personality?

A: I would describe myself as ambitious, motivated, and friendly. I'm also quite imaginative, which helps in my studies and hobbies.

8. Q: What trait do you admire most in people?

A: I admire honesty the most. It's the foundation of any strong relationship.

9. Q: What does your favorite teacher look like?

A: My favorite teacher has short gray hair and glasses. She's always neatly dressed in professional attire.

10. Q: What traits does your favorite teacher possess that you admire?

A: My favorite teacher is very knowledgeable and patient. She also has a great sense of humor which makes her classes enjoyable.

11. Q: How would you describe your family members?

A: My dad is tall with dark hair and glasses, and he's very intelligent and serious. My mom is of average height, has light hair, and she's very kind and caring.

12. Q: Can you describe your favorite fictional character's appearance and personality?

A: Sherlock Holmes, my favorite fictional character, is described as having sharp, piercing eyes and a lean figure. He is highly intelligent, observant, and a little eccentric.

13. Q: What traits do you share with your favorite fictional character?

A: Like Sherlock Holmes, I value logic and have a keen eye for detail. However, I'm definitely not as eccentric as he is!

14. Q: How would you describe your personal style?

A: I'd describe my personal style as casual and comfortable. I usually wear jeans and t-shirts.

15. Q: What trait do you most value in your friends?

A: The trait I most value in my friends is loyalty. It's important to me to have friends who are dependable and trustworthy.

16. Q: Can you describe a person you admire?

A: I admire Malala Yousafzai. She is a young woman with dark hair and a gentle smile. More importantly, she's brave, intelligent, and dedicated to her cause.

17. Q: What do you think is the most important personality trait for a student?

A: I believe motivation is the most important trait for a student. A motivated student will continue to learn and grow, even when faced with challenges.

18. Q: How would you describe your favorite author?

A: My favorite author, J.K. Rowling, is a woman with brown hair and blue eyes. She has a vibrant personality, is incredibly imaginative, and has a great storytelling ability.

19. Q: How do you describe a person you don't like without being mean?

A: I could say that our personalities simply don't match. They might have a very different perspective or approach to things that doesn't align with mine.

20. Q: Can you describe the personality of someone who makes a good leader?

A: A good leader is confident, communicative, and compassionate. They should be decisive and possess the ability to inspire others.

Lesson 7: Hometown and Landmarks

New Words and Definitions:

1. Hometown: The town or city where a person was born or grew up.
2. Landmark: An object or feature of a landscape or town that is easily seen and recognized from a distance, especially one that enables someone to establish their location.
3. Historical: Connected with history; based on events in history (whether regarded as important or not).
4. Architecture: The style and design of buildings.
5. Scenery: The natural features of a landscape considered in terms of their appearance, especially when picturesque.
6. Population: The number of people living in a particular area.
7. Environment: The surroundings or conditions in which a person, animal, or plant lives or operates.
8. Urban: In, relating to, or characteristic of a town or city.
9. Rural: In, relating to, or characteristic of the countryside rather than the town.
10. Traditional: Existing in or as part of a tradition; long-established.
11. Culture: The customs, arts, social institutions, and achievements of a particular nation, people, or other social group.
12. Festival: An event ordinarily celebrated by a community and centering on some characteristic aspect of that community and its religion or cultures.
13. Local cuisine: Food that is typical of a particular area or region.
14. Tourist attraction: A place of interest where tourists visit, typically for its inherent or an exhibited natural or cultural value, historical significance, natural or built beauty.
15. Economy: The wealth and resources of a country or region, especially in terms of the production and consumption of goods and services.
16. Neighborhood: A district or community within a town or city.
17. Public transportation: Buses, trains, etc. that are available for the public to use.
18. Weather: The state of the atmosphere at a particular place and time as regards heat, cloudiness, dryness, sunshine, wind, rain, etc.

19. Community: A group of people living in the same place or having a particular characteristic in common.

20. Nature: The phenomena of the physical world collectively, including plants, animals, the landscape, and other features and products of the earth.

Questions and Sample Answers:

1. Q: Can you describe your hometown?

A: My hometown is a medium-sized city with a population of about 500,000. It's known for its beautiful scenery and historical architecture.

2. Q: What are some notable landmarks in your hometown?

A: Some notable landmarks in my hometown include the Maiden Tower, an ancient monument with rich history, and the Baku Crystal Hall, an indoor arena that has hosted many international events.

3. Q: What makes your hometown special?

A: My hometown is special because it's a mix of old and new, traditional and modern. We have historical landmarks as well as modern buildings, and a vibrant culture that respects the past while embracing the future.

4. Q: Can you describe the architecture in your hometown?

A: The architecture in my hometown is diverse. We have ancient buildings in the Old City, Soviet-era buildings, as well as modern skyscrapers like the Flame Towers.

5. Q: What is the population of your hometown?

A: The population of my hometown is about 500,000 people.

6. Q: Is your hometown urban or rural?

A: My hometown is urban, but there are some rural areas on the outskirts.

7. Q: What are some traditional festivals or events in your hometown?

A: One traditional festival in my hometown is Novruz, which marks the Persian New Year and the arrival of spring. It's a big celebration with lots of food, music, and dances.

8. Q: Can you describe the local cuisine in your hometown?

A: The local cuisine in my hometown is a mix of Middle Eastern and Eastern European flavors. Popular dishes include plov, a type of rice pilaf, and shashlik, which are skewered and grilled cubes of meat.

9. Q: What are some popular tourist attractions in your hometown?

A: Some popular tourist attractions in my hometown include the Old City, which is a UNESCO World Heritage site, and the Heydar Aliyev Center, which is known for its distinctive architecture.

10. Q: How does the economy of your hometown rely on?

A: The economy of my hometown relies mainly on oil and gas industry, but tourism and IT sectors are also growing rapidly.

11. Q: Can you describe the weather in your hometown?

A: The weather in my hometown varies by season. Summers are hot and dry, while winters are mild and wet.

12. Q: How would you describe the community in your hometown?

A: The community in my hometown is diverse and vibrant. People are generally friendly and welcoming.

13. Q: What are the forms of public transportation available in your hometown?

A: In my hometown, we have buses, metro, and taxis for public transportation.

14. Q: What is your favorite thing about your hometown?

A: My favorite thing about my hometown is its rich history and culture. I also love the local food.

15. Q: What is a typical day like in your hometown?

A: A typical day in my hometown starts early with people going to work or school. In the evening, people often go out for a walk or meet friends at cafes.

16. Q: How has your hometown influenced who you are today?

A: Growing up in my hometown has taught me to appreciate different cultures and histories. It has also instilled in me a love for nature and the outdoors.

17. Q: If someone were to visit your hometown, what should they do or see?

A: If someone were to visit my hometown, they should definitely explore the Old City, try local cuisine, and visit the Flame Towers for a panoramic view of the city.

18. Q: How would you describe the nature in and around your hometown?

A: The nature in and around my hometown is beautiful. We have a coastline along the Caspian Sea, as well as mountains and forests in the surrounding regions.

19. Q: Can you describe a typical neighborhood in your hometown?

A: A typical neighborhood in my hometown has a mix of residential buildings and local businesses. There are parks where children can play, and people often gather in the evenings for a chat.

20. Q: How have the landmarks in your hometown influenced its culture?

A: The landmarks in my hometown have shaped its culture by being a testament to our history. They serve as reminders of our past and inspire our art and storytelling.

Lesson 8: Food and Drinks

New Words and Definitions:

1. Appetizer: A small dish of food or a drink taken before a meal or the main course as a starter.
2. Main course: The principal dish of a meal.
3. Dessert: The sweet course eaten at the end of a meal.
4. Beverage: A drink of any type.
5. Recipe: A set of instructions for preparing a particular dish, including a list of the ingredients required.
6. Cuisine: A style or method of cooking, especially as characteristic of a particular country, region, or establishment.
7. Vegetarian: A person who does not eat meat or fish, and sometimes other animal products, especially for moral, religious, or health reasons.
8. Vegan: A person who does not eat or use any animal products.
9. Spicy: Having a strong, hot flavor.
10. Sweet: Having the pleasant taste characteristic of sugar or honey; not salty, sour, or bitter.
11. Salty: Tasting of, containing, or preserved with salt.
12. Sour: Having an acid taste like lemon or vinegar.
13. Bitter: Having a sharp, pungent taste or smell; not sweet.
14. Utensils: A tool, container, or other article, especially for household use.
15. Portion: A part of a whole; an amount, section, or piece of something.
16. Nutrition: The process of providing or obtaining the food necessary for health and growth.
17. Diet: The kinds of food that a person, animal, or community habitually eats.
18. Allergy: A damaging immune response by the body to a substance, especially pollen, fur, a particular food, or dust, to which it has become hypersensitive.
19. Ingredients: Any of the foods or substances that are combined to make a particular dish.
20. Beverage: A liquid to consume, often excluding water; a drink.

Questions and Sample Answers:

1. Q: What is your favorite food?

A: My favorite food is dolma, a traditional Azerbaijani dish made of grape leaves stuffed with minced meat and rice.

2. Q: Can you describe the taste of your favorite food?

A: Dolma has a savory and slightly tangy taste. The grape leaves give it a unique flavor that complements the filling.

3. Q: What kind of foods do you usually have for breakfast, lunch, and dinner?

A: For breakfast, I usually have bread, cheese, and tea. For lunch, I often have a main dish like plov or shashlik. Dinner is typically lighter, with soup or salad.

4. Q: Are you a vegetarian or vegan? If not, would you consider becoming one?

A: I'm not a vegetarian or vegan, but I try to incorporate plenty of fruits and vegetables into my diet. I would consider becoming a vegetarian for health reasons.

5. Q: Do you like spicy food? Why or why not?

A: I enjoy spicy food because it adds an extra kick and flavor to dishes. But I don't like it when it's so spicy that it overpowers other flavors.

6. Q: What's a traditional dish from your country that you would recommend to others?

A: I would recommend trying plov. It's a flavorful rice dish cooked with meat, vegetables, and spices.

7. Q: Do you enjoy cooking? What's your favorite dish to prepare?

A: Yes, I enjoy cooking. My favorite dish to prepare is shashlik because I love the process of marinating the meat and grilling it.

8. Q: Can you describe the process of making your favorite dish?

A: To make shashlik, you first marinate the meat in a mixture of spices, onion, and yogurt. Then you thread the meat onto skewers and grill it until it's perfectly cooked.

9. Q: Do you have any food allergies?

A: No, I don't have any food allergies.

10. Q: What is your favorite drink?

A: My favorite drink is Ayran, a traditional yogurt-based beverage.

11. Q: Do you prefer homemade meals or dining out?

A: I enjoy both. Homemade meals are comforting and healthy, but I also like dining out to try new cuisines.

12. Q: Can you describe your diet?

A: My diet is balanced. I try to eat a variety of foods, including grains, proteins, fruits, and vegetables.

13. Q: What is your favorite dessert?

A: My favorite dessert is baklava, a sweet pastry made of layers of filo filled with chopped nuts and sweetened with syrup or honey.

14. Q: What foods or drinks do you consume to stay healthy?

A: To stay healthy, I consume lots of fruits and vegetables, lean proteins, and healthy fats. I also drink plenty of water.

15. Q: How do you order food in a restaurant?

A: I usually start by looking at the menu, then I ask the waiter for recommendations if I can't decide. I specify any preferences or dietary restrictions I have, and then I place my order.

16. Q: How would you describe your country's cuisine to someone who's never tried it?

A: Azerbaijani cuisine is a mix of Middle Eastern and Eastern European flavors. It features a lot of meat dishes, rice, and vegetables, and the flavors are rich and hearty.

17. Q: What ingredients are commonly used in your country's cuisine?

A: Common ingredients in Azerbaijani cuisine include lamb, rice, vegetables, and various spices.

18. Q: What is a common beverage in your country?

A: A common beverage in Azerbaijan is tea. It's traditionally served in a pear-shaped glass and is often enjoyed with sweets or pastries.

19. Q: What is a typical portion size for meals in your country?

A: In Azerbaijan, the portion sizes are usually quite generous. A typical meal might include a main dish, a side dish, and a salad.

20. Q: Can you describe the nutrition value of your favorite dish?

A: Dolma, my favorite dish, is quite nutritious. It's high in protein from the minced meat and has a good amount of fiber from the grape leaves and rice.

Lesson 9: Shopping and Money

New Words and Definitions:

1. Budget: An estimate of income and expenditure for a set period of time.
2. Bargain: Negotiate the terms and conditions of a transaction.
3. Discount: A deduction from the usual cost of something.
4. Sale: The exchange of a commodity for money; the action of selling something.
5. Cashback: A perk offered by banks where a small percentage of the amount spent is paid back to the card holder.
6. Credit Card: A small plastic card issued by a bank, business, etc., allowing the holder to purchase goods or services on credit.
7. Price: The amount of money expected, required, or given in payment for something.
8. Receipt: A written or printed statement acknowledging that something has been paid for or that goods have been received.
9. Refund: Pay back (money), typically to a customer who is not satisfied with goods or services bought.
10. Exchange: Give something and receive something of the same kind in return.
11. Shopping Mall: A large enclosed building featuring a variety of shops and often restaurants.
12. Market: A regular gathering of people for the purchase and sale of provisions, livestock, and other commodities.
13. Online Shopping: The activity of buying products or services over the Internet.
14. Outfit: A set of clothes worn together, typically for a particular occasion or purpose.
15. Fashion: A popular or the latest style of clothing, hair, decoration, or behavior.
16. Spending Habits: The way in which one tends to spend their money.
17. Savings: The money one has saved, especially through a bank or official scheme.
18. Scholarship: A payment made to support a student's education, awarded on the basis of academic or other achievement.
19. Expenses: The cost required for something; the money spent on something.
20. Currency: A system of money in general use in a particular country.

Questions and Sample Answers:

1. Q: Where do you usually do your shopping?

A: I usually do my shopping at the local market and sometimes at shopping malls.

2. Q: What do you typically spend your money on?

A: I typically spend my money on outfits and language learning courses.

3. Q: How do you budget your monthly expenses?

A: I make a list of my necessary expenses, such as for courses, clothes, and personal needs, and allocate my money accordingly. I also try to save a little each month.

4. Q: Can you describe a time when you got a good bargain?

A: Once, I was at the market and saw a beautiful dress. The initial price was quite high, but after some bargaining, the seller gave me a significant discount.

5. Q: How do you feel about online shopping?

A: I think online shopping is very convenient, but I prefer going to the shops in person so I can see and try the items before buying.

6. Q: How often do you shop for new outfits?

A: I shop for new outfits about once a month or whenever I see something I really like.

7. Q: Do you prefer paying with cash or credit card?

A: I prefer paying with a credit card because it provides cashback, which helps me save money in the long run.

8. Q: What is the most expensive thing you've ever bought?

A: The most expensive thing I've bought is a language learning course. It was costly, but it was worth it because it helped me improve my skills.

9. Q: What do you do if you're not satisfied with a purchase?

A: If I'm not satisfied with a purchase, I usually return it and ask for a refund or exchange.

10. Q: How do you save money?

A: I save money by setting aside a portion of my income each month. I also take advantage of the cashback feature when shopping with my credit card.

11. Q: Where does your money come from?

A: I receive money from my parents, and I also have a scholarship of 170 manats.

12. Q: What are your biggest monthly expenses?

A: My biggest monthly expenses are my language courses and clothing purchases.

13. Q: Do you like to follow fashion trends?

A: I like to keep up with fashion trends, but I also prioritize comfort and personal style when choosing my outfits.

14. Q: Have you ever had to ask for a refund?

A: Yes, I once bought a dress online, but when it arrived, it didn't look as good as in the pictures, so I asked for a refund.

15. Q: Do you enjoy bargaining when shopping?

A: Yes, I enjoy bargaining. It's quite common in Azerbaijan, and it can be fun and rewarding to negotiate a good price.

16. Q: How do you decide if something is worth buying?

A: I consider the quality, price, and how much I need or want it. If it's a high-quality item that I'll use a lot, and the price is reasonable, then it's worth buying.

17. Q: What is your attitude towards spending and saving?

A: I believe in balancing spending and saving. It's important to enjoy life and treat ourselves, but also to save for the future.

18. Q: Have you ever lost or misplaced your money?

A: Once, I misplaced my wallet, but luckily, I found it at home. I was very relieved.

19. Q: How important is money to you?

A: Money is important because it provides for my needs and allows me to pursue my interests, like learning languages. But it's not the most important thing in life.

20. Q: How does the cost of living in your city compare to other cities in Azerbaijan?

A: The cost of living in my city is a bit higher compared to other cities in Azerbaijan, especially for rent and dining out.

Lesson 10: Weather and Seasons

New Words and Definitions:

1. Weather: The state of the atmosphere at a place and time as regards heat, dryness, sunshine, wind, rain, etc.
2. Seasons: Each of the four divisions of the year (spring, summer, autumn, and winter) marked by particular weather patterns and daylight hours.
3. Forecast: A prediction or estimate of future events, especially coming weather.
4. Climate: The weather conditions prevailing in an area in general or over a long period.
5. Temperature: The degree of internal heat of a person's body.
6. Heatwave: A prolonged period of abnormally hot weather.
7. Cool: Of or at a fairly low temperature.
8. Rain: Moisture condensed from the atmosphere that falls visibly in separate drops.
9. Snow: Atmospheric water vapor frozen into ice crystals and falling in light white flakes or lying on the ground as a white layer.
10. Wind: The natural movement of the air, especially in the form of a current of air blowing from a particular direction.
11. Humidity: The state or quality of being humid (a quantity representing the amount of water vapor in the atmosphere).
12. Sunshine: The light and heat that come from the sun.
13. Storm: A violent disturbance of the atmosphere with strong winds and usually rain, thunder, lightning, or snow.
14. Picnic: An outing or occasion that involves taking a packed meal to be eaten outdoors.
15. Mood: A temporary state of mind or feeling.
16. Activity: The condition in which things are happening or being done.

Questions and Sample Answers:

1. Q: What is your favorite season and why?

A: My favorite season is summer because I love the warm weather and being able to spend time outdoors.

2. Q: How does the weather affect your mood?

A: When it's sunny, I feel more energetic and happy. But when it's rainy, I feel a bit lazy and prefer to stay indoors.

3. Q: Can you describe the typical climate in your hometown?

A: The climate in my hometown is quite varied. We have hot summers and mild winters.

4. Q: What activities do you enjoy doing in different seasons?

A: In the summer, I enjoy going on picnics with my friends to places like Nabran, Shusha, and Ordubad. In the winter, I prefer indoor activities like reading or studying.

5. Q: How often do you check the weather forecast?

A: I check the weather forecast every morning to plan my day and outfit accordingly.

6. Q: Can you describe a time when the weather affected your plans?

A: Last summer, we planned to go on a picnic, but it started raining unexpectedly. So we had to postpone it.

7. Q: What is your favorite type of weather?

A: My favorite type of weather is sunny and warm. I enjoy the sunshine and clear skies.

8. Q: How do you usually spend your summers?

A: I usually spend my summers travelling and exploring new places with my friends. Next summer, we're planning to visit Marmaris in Turkey.

9. Q: Have you ever experienced extreme weather conditions?

A: Once, during a heatwave, the temperatures soared above 40 degrees Celsius. It was extremely hot, and we had to stay indoors most of the time.

10. Q: What kind of clothes do you wear in different seasons?

A: In summer, I wear light, airy clothes like dresses and shorts. In winter, I wear warm clothes like jackets and sweaters.

11. Q: Do you prefer hot or cold weather?

A: I prefer hot weather because I can do more outdoor activities.

12. Q: How does the weather influence your daily routine?

A: The weather significantly influences my daily routine. On rainy days, I prefer staying indoors and studying or reading. On sunny days, I love going out and meeting friends.

13. Q: What is the weather like today?

A: Today, the weather is sunny with a light breeze. It's a perfect day for an outing.

14. Q: Have you ever been caught in a storm?

A: Yes, once I was caught in a heavy rainstorm. I was totally soaked by the time I reached home.

15. Q: What do you like to do on a sunny day?

A: On a sunny day, I like to go out for a walk or meet my friends for a picnic.

16. Q: Do you like snow? Why or why not?

A: I like snow because it makes everything look so beautiful and serene. But it can be a bit inconvenient when it comes to transportation.

17. Q: How does the weather change in different seasons in your city?

A: In my city, the weather changes significantly with each season. Summers are hot and dry, while winters are mild and wet.

18. Q: Do you prefer a picnic on a sunny day or a rainy day?

A: I prefer a picnic on a sunny day because it's more enjoyable to be outside when the weather is nice.

19. Q: Do you agree that climate change is affecting weather patterns?

A: Yes, I believe that climate change is causing more extreme and unpredictable weather patterns.

20. Q: How do you protect yourself from the sun in summer?

A: I protect myself from the sun by wearing sunscreen, sunglasses, and a hat when I go out.

Lesson 11: Travel and Holidays

New Words and Definitions:

1. Travel: Make a journey, typically of some length or abroad.
2. Holidays: An extended period of leisure and recreation, especially one spent away from home or in travelling.
3. Destination: The place to which someone or something is going or being sent.
4. Adventure: An unusual and exciting or daring experience.
5. Explore: Travel in or through (an unfamiliar country or area) in order to learn about or familiarize oneself with it.
6. Culture: The customs, arts, social institutions, and achievements of a particular nation, people, or other social group.
7. Tradition: The transmission of customs or beliefs from generation to generation, or the fact of being passed on in this way.
8. Accommodation: A room, group of rooms, or building in which someone may live or stay.
9. Transport: A system or means of conveying people or goods from place to place.
10. Sightseeing: The activity of visiting the sights of a place.
11. Landmark: An object or feature of a landscape or town that is easily seen and recognized from a distance, especially one that enables someone to establish their location.
12. Souvenir: A thing that is kept as a reminder of a person, place, or event.
13. Itinerary: A planned route or journey.
14. Passport: An official document issued by a government, certifying the holder's identity and citizenship and entitling them to travel under its protection to and from foreign countries.
15. Visa: An endorsement on a passport indicating that the holder is allowed to enter, leave, or stay for a specified period in a country.
16. Customs: The official department that administers and collects the duties levied by a government on imported goods.
17. Reservation: An arrangement whereby something, especially a seat or room, is booked or reserved for a particular person.
18. Tourist: A person who is traveling or visiting a place for pleasure.

Questions and Sample Answers:

1. Q: Have you ever traveled abroad?

A: Yes, I've traveled to several countries with my family. We love exploring new places and experiencing different cultures.

2. Q: What is your dream travel destination and why?

A: My dream travel destination is Japan. I'm fascinated by its rich culture, ancient traditions, and beautiful landscapes.

3. Q: Can you share a memorable travel experience?

A: Last summer, I visited Turkey with my friends. We spent a week exploring the historic sites, trying local food, and shopping at local markets. It was an unforgettable experience.

4. Q: How do you plan your trips?

A: I usually start by researching the destination and creating an itinerary. Then I book accommodations and transportation. I also make sure to pack all the essentials.

5. Q: What do you usually do on holidays?

A: On holidays, I usually spend time with my family. We often go on trips or celebrate at home with a special meal.

6. Q: What's the most interesting cultural tradition you've learned about while traveling?

A: When I visited India, I learned about the tradition of Diwali, a festival of lights celebrated by Hindus. It was really fascinating.

7. Q: Have you ever experienced a travel mishap?

A: Yes, once I missed a connecting flight due to a delay. It was a bit stressful, but I managed to get on the next flight.

8. Q: What's your favorite part about traveling?

A: My favorite part about traveling is experiencing new cultures, meeting new people, and trying new food.

9. Q: How do you prepare for a trip?

A: I prepare for a trip by doing thorough research about the destination, planning my itinerary, packing, and making all necessary reservations.

10. Q: What are some holiday traditions in your culture?

A: In my culture, we celebrate Novruz Bayram, a holiday that marks the beginning of spring. We prepare special meals, visit family and friends, and enjoy outdoor activities.

11. Q: What are some things you always bring when you travel?

A: I always bring my passport, a map, comfortable clothes, a camera, and a travel guide when I travel.

12. Q: How do you handle language barriers when you travel?

A: I try to learn some basic phrases in the local language. I also use translation apps when necessary.

13. Q: Have you ever traveled alone?

A: Yes, I've traveled alone a few times. It's a different experience, but I enjoy the independence and flexibility it offers.

14. Q: What is one place you would like to visit again?

A: I would love to visit Istanbul again. The city has a unique blend of cultures, and there's so much to see and do.

15. Q: What are some must-visit places in your country?

A: In Azerbaijan, you must visit Baku, the capital city, Gobustan National Park for its ancient rock carvings, and the beautiful old town of Sheki.

16. Q: How do you keep yourself entertained during long journeys?

A: I keep myself entertained by reading, listening to music, or playing games on my phone.

17. Q: What's the longest journey you've ever been on?

A: The longest journey I've ever been on was a 15-hour flight to the United States.

18. Q: Have you ever visited a place just because you saw it in a book, movie, or on TV?

A: Yes, after watching the movie 'In Bruges', I was inspired to visit Bruges in Belgium. It was just as beautiful as it was in the movie.

19. Q: Do you prefer to travel by plane, train, car, or boat?

A: I prefer traveling by plane because it's the fastest way to get to faraway places. But I also enjoy train journeys for the scenic views.

20. Q: What advice would you give to someone who is traveling for the first time?

A: I would advise them to do thorough research about the destination, pack light, keep important documents handy, and most importantly, enjoy the experience.

Lesson 12: Pets and Animals

New Words and Definitions:

1. Pet: A domestic or tamed animal kept for companionship or pleasure.
2. Animal: A living organism that feeds on organic matter, typically having specialized sense organs and nervous system and able to respond rapidly to stimuli.
3. Care: The provision of what is necessary for the health, welfare, maintenance, and protection of someone or something.
4. Characteristics: A feature or quality belonging typically to a person, place, or thing and serving to identify them.
5. Feed: Give food to.
6. Breed: A stock of animals or plants within a species having a distinctive appearance and typically having been developed by deliberate selection.
7. Training: The action of teaching a person or animal a particular skill or type of behavior.
8. Behavior: The way in which one acts or conducts oneself, especially towards others.
9. Habit: A settled or regular tendency or practice.
10. Wildlife: Wild animals collectively; the native fauna (and sometimes flora) of a region.
11. Veterinary: Relating to the diseases, injuries, and treatment of farm and domestic animals.
12. Playful: Fond of games and amusement; lighthearted.
13. Loyal: Giving or showing firm and constant support or allegiance to a person or institution.
14. Aquatic: Relating to water; living in or near water or taking place in water.
15. Furry: Covered with fur.
16. Reptile: A cold-blooded vertebrate of a class that includes snakes, lizards, crocodiles, turtles, and tortoises.
17. Bird: A warm-blooded egg-laying vertebrate distinguished by the possession of feathers, wings, and a beak and (typically) by being able to fly.
18. Fish: A limbless cold-blooded vertebrate animal with gills and fins and living wholly in water.

19. Mammal: A warm-blooded vertebrate animal of a class that is distinguished by the possession of hair or fur, the secretion of milk by females for the nourishment of the young, and (typically) the birth of live young.

20. Insect: A small arthropod animal that has six legs and generally one or two pairs of wings.

Questions and Sample Answers:

1. Q: Do you have any pets?

A: Yes, I have a cat named Yumru Top and a dog named Alabash.

2. Q: What is your favorite animal and why?

A: My favorite animal is the dolphin because they are intelligent and friendly creatures.

3. Q: How do you take care of your pets?

A: I feed them healthy food, ensure they get regular exercise, and take them for regular check-ups at the vet.

4. Q: What are some characteristics of your pets?

A: Yumru Top, my cat, is very independent and curious. Alabash, my dog, is very playful and loyal.

5. Q: Have you ever seen a wild animal? Where and what was it?

A: Yes, I have seen a deer in the forest near my grandparents' house.

6. Q: Would you ever consider having an exotic animal as a pet? Why or why not?

A: No, I wouldn't. Exotic animals belong in their natural habitats and it can be difficult and unethical to keep them as pets.

7. Q: What are some differences between taking care of a dog and a cat?

A: Dogs usually require more attention and exercise than cats. Cats are more independent and can be left alone for longer periods of time.

8. Q: Have you ever been scared of an animal? Why?

A: I was scared of spiders when I was younger because I didn't like their appearance. But now I understand that they are harmless and important for the ecosystem.

9. Q: Have you ever visited a zoo or an animal shelter? How was the experience?

A: Yes, I have visited a zoo. It was interesting to see a variety of animals, but I also felt sad because they were not in their natural habitats.

10. Q: What animal would you like to see in the wild?

A: I would love to see a whale in the wild. It must be an amazing sight.

11. Q: How important do you think it is to protect endangered animals?

A: I think it's extremely important. Every animal plays a unique role in the ecosystem and losing them can disrupt the balance of nature.

12. Q: Would you like to work with animals in the future? In what way?

A: Yes, I would love to work as a vet because I love animals and would like to help them.

13. Q: If you were an animal, what would you be and why?

A: If I were an animal, I would be a bird so I could fly and see the world from above.

14. Q: What are some interesting animal facts you know?

A: Did you know that an octopus has three hearts and the blood is blue?

15. Q: Have you ever tried to teach your pets any tricks?

A: Yes, I've taught my dog Alabash to fetch a ball.

16. Q: What kind of animals are popular pets in your country?

A: In Azerbaijan, dogs, cats, and birds are popular pets.

17. Q: Do you think animals should be kept in zoos?

A: I have mixed feelings about this. Zoos can play a role in conservation and education, but it's also important that animals live in suitable conditions.

18. Q: Have you ever had a strange encounter with an animal?

A: Once, a bird landed on my shoulder when I was in a park. It was a surprise, but a pleasant one!

19. Q: How do pets influence the lives of their owners?

A: Pets provide companionship, reduce stress, and can even help their owners maintain a healthier lifestyle.

20. Q: How can we teach younger generations about animal care and conservation?

A: We can teach younger generations through education, visits to animal shelters and conservation sites, and by setting a good example in our own treatment of animals.

Lesson 13: Jobs and Professions

New Words and Definitions:

1. Job: A paid position of regular employment.
2. Profession: A paid occupation, especially one that involves prolonged training and a formal qualification.
3. Duty: A task or action that one is required to perform as part of one's job.
4. Career: An occupation undertaken for a significant period of a person's life and with opportunities for progress.
5. Aspiration: A hope or ambition of achieving something.
6. Salary: A fixed regular payment, typically paid monthly or biweekly but often expressed as an annual sum, made by an employer to an employee.
7. Part-time: Working less than full-time.
8. Full-time: Working the full number of hours considered standard or normal.
9. Overtime: Time worked in addition to one's normal working hours.
10. Colleague: A person with whom one works, especially in a profession or business.
11. Boss: A person in charge of a worker or organization.
12. Employee: A person employed for wages or salary, especially at non-executive level.
13. Employer: A person or organization that employs people.
14. Skills: The ability to do something well; expertise.
15. Experience: Practical contact with and observation of facts or events.
16. Benefits: An advantage or profit gained from something.
17. Job satisfaction: The level of happiness one feels about every aspect of their job.
18. Career path: The progression, or series of steps or stages, in one's work life.
19. Internship: A temporary position with an emphasis on on-the-job training rather than merely employment.
20. Freelancer: A person who works as a writer, designer, performer, or the like, selling work or services by the hour, day, job, etc., rather than working on a regular salary basis for one employer.

Questions and Sample Answers:

1. Q: What job would you like to have in the future?

A: I would like to be a software engineer because I am interested in technology and coding.

2. Q: What is your dream job and why?

A: My dream job is to become a travel writer. I love both travelling and writing, and I think it would be amazing to combine these passions.

3. Q: What do you think are the most important skills for your dream job?

A: For being a travel writer, I think the most important skills are good writing skills, creativity, and a keen sense of adventure.

4. Q: What are some duties of a software engineer?

A: A software engineer is responsible for designing, coding, testing, and debugging software applications. They also collaborate with other team members to solve problems and improve software quality.

5. Q: What kind of jobs are popular in your country?

A: In Azerbaijan, some popular jobs include working in the oil industry, healthcare, education, and information technology.

6. Q: What do you think about working part-time while studying?

A: I think it can be a good idea if you can manage your time effectively. It not only helps you earn money but also provides work experience.

7. Q: What are the advantages and disadvantages of being a freelancer?

A: Being a freelancer offers the flexibility of working whenever and wherever you want. However, the income might not be stable and there could be a lack of job security.

8. Q: Would you prefer a job with a high salary but less job satisfaction or a job with a low salary but high job satisfaction?

A: I would prefer a job with high job satisfaction. Money is important, but I believe enjoying what you do is more crucial in the long run.

9. Q: What are some benefits employees might expect from their jobs?

A: Some benefits employees might expect include health insurance, retirement plans, paid time off, and sometimes bonuses or profit-sharing.

10. Q: Would you consider doing an internship to gain work experience?

A: Yes, I think internships are a great way to gain practical experience and learn more about a particular industry or profession.

11. Q: How do you think technology has changed the job market?

A: Technology has created new job opportunities, especially in fields like information technology and data science. However, it also makes some jobs obsolete due to automation.

12. Q: What's the difference between a job and a career?

A: A job is a specific position or work for which you get paid, while a career is a long-term professional journey with opportunities for growth and progression.

13. Q: How important is it to have good relationships with colleagues at work?

A: It's very important. Good relationships with colleagues can make the work environment more enjoyable and productive.

14. Q: What kind of job do you think you would be terrible at?

A: I think I would be terrible at any job that requires meticulous attention to detail, like accounting, as I prefer creative tasks.

15. Q: Would you like to be a boss someday?

A: Yes, I would like to be a boss someday. I believe it would be rewarding to lead a team and make decisions that impact the success of a business.

16. Q: What can a person do to increase their chances of getting a job they want?

A: They can gain relevant skills and experiences, network with professionals in the field, and tailor their application materials to highlight their suitability for the job.

17. Q: How do you think the job market will change in the future?

A: I believe there will be more remote work opportunities, increased demand for tech skills, and possibly fewer traditional full-time jobs due to automation and the gig economy.

18. Q: What would you do if you were unhappy with your job?

A: If I were unhappy with my job, I would first try to identify the reasons and see if there are any changes I could make. If that didn't help, I would consider looking for a new job that better suits my interests and goals.

19. Q: Is it important to have a career path planned out?

A: It can be helpful, but it's also okay not to have everything planned out. Career paths are often non-linear, and it's important to be open to unexpected opportunities.

20. Q: What do you think is the most challenging aspect of job hunting?

A: The most challenging aspect of job hunting might be dealing with rejection and staying motivated during the process.

Lesson 14: Health and Wellness

New Words and Definitions:

1. Health: The state of being free from illness or injury.
2. Wellness: The state of being in good health, especially as an actively pursued goal.
3. Habit: A settled or regular tendency or practice.
4. Illness: A disease or period of sickness affecting the body or mind.
5. Doctor: A qualified practitioner of medicine; a physician.
6. Patient: A person receiving or registered to receive medical treatment.
7. Prescription: An instruction written by a medical practitioner that authorizes a patient to be provided a medicine or treatment.
8. Exercise: Physical activity and movement, especially when intended to keep a person fit and healthy.
9. Diet: The kinds of food that a person, animal, or community habitually eats.
10. Stress: A state of mental or emotional strain or tension resulting from adverse or demanding circumstances.
11. Rest: Cease work or movement in order to relax, refresh oneself, or recover strength.
12. Check-up: A thorough examination of a person's body by a doctor, usually done regularly to prevent illness.
13. Medicine: The science or practice of the diagnosis, treatment, and prevention of disease.
14. Symptom: A physical or mental feature which is regarded as indicating a condition of disease.
15. Pain: A feeling of discomfort or distress; hurt.
16. Allergy: An exaggerated immune response or reaction to substances that are generally not harmful.
17. Injury: Harm or damage.
18. Physical: Relating to the body as opposed to the mind.
19. Mental: Relating to the mind.
20. Nutrition: The process of providing or obtaining the food necessary for health and growth.

Questions and Sample Answers:

1. Q: How would you describe your eating habits?

A: I try to eat a balanced diet with plenty of fruits and vegetables, but I also indulge in sweets occasionally.

2. Q: What do you do to stay healthy?

A: To stay healthy, I exercise regularly, eat a balanced diet, and make sure to get enough sleep.

3. Q: Have you ever had an allergic reaction to something?

A: Yes, I have an allergy to pollen. In the spring, I often have sneezing fits and watery eyes.

4. Q: How often do you go for a check-up?

A: I go for a general health check-up once a year to make sure everything is alright.

5. Q: If you have a headache, what do you usually do?

A: If I have a headache, I usually take a rest and drink lots of water. If it's severe, I might take a pain reliever.

6. Q: What are some common illnesses in your country?

A: Some common illnesses in Azerbaijan include cardiovascular diseases, respiratory infections, and diabetes.

7. Q: How can stress affect our health?

A: Stress can negatively impact our health in various ways. It can lead to headaches, upset stomach, elevated blood pressure, and can also impact our mental health causing anxiety and depression.

8. Q: What does a healthy lifestyle look like to you?

A: A healthy lifestyle to me includes a balanced diet, regular exercise, enough sleep, good mental health, and regular medical check-ups.

9. Q: How important is it to you to stay physically active?

A: It's very important to me. Staying physically active not only helps maintain a healthy weight, but it also boosts mood and energy levels.

10. Q: What would you say to a friend who smokes to persuade them to quit?

A: I would tell them about the numerous health risks associated with smoking, including heart disease and cancer. I would also offer to help them find resources to quit smoking.

11. Q: How would you describe your sleeping habits?

A: I generally get a good amount of sleep. I try to go to bed and wake up at the same time every day to maintain a consistent sleep schedule.

12. Q: How does one's diet affect their health?

A: A poor diet can lead to health problems like obesity, heart disease, diabetes, and cancer. On the other hand, a balanced diet provides the nutrients necessary for growth and repair, helps prevent diet-related illness, and makes one feel good overall.

13. Q: What are some ways to manage stress?

A: Some ways to manage stress include regular exercise, deep breathing, meditation, spending time with loved ones, and pursuing hobbies or interests.

14. Q: What are some habits that can harm our health?

A: Some habits that can harm our health include smoking, excessive alcohol consumption, lack of physical activity, unhealthy diet, and not getting enough sleep.

15. Q: If you felt really sick, what would you do?

A: If I felt really sick, I would rest and drink lots of fluids. If my symptoms didn't improve or got worse, I would see a doctor.

16. Q: What are the benefits of regular exercise?

A: Regular exercise can help control weight, reduce risk of heart diseases, help your body manage blood sugar and insulin levels, improve mental health and mood, and promote better sleep.

17. Q: Why is mental health important?

A: Mental health is important because it affects how we think, feel, and act. It also helps determine how we handle stress, relate to others, and make choices.

18. Q: Do you believe in taking vitamins or supplements?

A: I think vitamins and supplements can be beneficial if you are deficient in certain nutrients, but they should not replace a balanced diet.

19. Q: How does sleep affect our health?

A: Lack of sleep can lead to various health problems like obesity, heart disease, and even decreased life expectancy. It can also affect our mood and cognitive abilities.

20. Q: How can one maintain good mental health?

A: Maintaining good mental health can involve regular exercise, a healthy diet, adequate sleep, staying socially connected, and seeking professional help when needed.

Lesson 15: Sports and Fitness

New Words and Definitions:

1. Sports: All forms of competitive physical activity which, through casual or organized participation, aim to use, maintain, or improve physical ability and skills.
2. Fitness: The condition of being physically fit and healthy.
3. Routine: A sequence of actions regularly followed.
4. Physical Activity: Any bodily movement produced by skeletal muscles that requires energy expenditure.
5. Team: A group of players forming one side in a competitive game or sport.
6. Score: The number of points, goals, runs, etc., achieved in a game.
7. Gym: A place where people go to exercise and stay in shape.
8. Exercise: Activity requiring physical effort, carried out to sustain or improve health and fitness.
9. Championship: A contest for the position of champion in a sport or game.
10. Player: A person who plays a sport or game.
11. Coach: A person who trains a person or team in a sport.
12. Field: An area of open land, especially one planted with crops or pasture, typically bounded by hedges or fences.
13. Track: A prepared course or circuit for athletes, horses, motor vehicles, bicycles, or dogs to race on.
14. Goal: The object of a person's ambition or effort; an aim or desired result.
15. Match: A sports contest or game.
16. Training: The action of teaching a person a particular skill or type of behavior.
17. Aerobic: Relating to, involving, or requiring free oxygen for life or activity.
18. Strength: The capacity of an object or substance to withstand great force or pressure.
19. Stamina: The ability to sustain prolonged physical or mental effort.
20. Flexibility: The quality of bending easily without breaking.

Questions and Sample Answers:

1. Q: What is your favorite sport and why?

A: My favorite sport is football because it is exciting and requires a lot of teamwork.

2. Q: How often do you exercise?

A: I try to exercise at least three times a week to keep fit.

3. Q: Do you prefer individual or team sports?

A: I prefer team sports because they promote teamwork and cooperation.

4. Q: Have you ever participated in a sports competition?

A: Yes, I have participated in a local tennis tournament before.

5. Q: What are the benefits of regular physical activity?

A: Regular physical activity can improve heart health, increase strength and flexibility, reduce stress, and boost mood.

6. Q: Who is your favorite athlete and why?

A: My favorite athlete is Lionel Messi because of his incredible skills and sportsmanship.

7. Q: How do you think sports and fitness contribute to our overall wellbeing?

A: Sports and fitness contribute to our overall wellbeing by improving our physical health, relieving stress, boosting self-esteem, and promoting social interaction.

8. Q: What types of exercises are included in your fitness routine?

A: My fitness routine includes cardio exercises like running and cycling, strength training with weights, and flexibility exercises like yoga.

9. Q: Do you prefer to work out in a gym or outdoors?

A: I prefer to work out in a gym because it has a variety of equipment and it's not dependent on the weather.

10. Q: How important is a healthy diet in relation to sports and fitness?

A: A healthy diet is crucial in relation to sports and fitness. It provides the necessary energy and nutrients needed for physical activity and recovery.

11. Q: What is the most challenging sport you have ever played?

A: The most challenging sport I've ever played is swimming because it requires strength, endurance, and technique.

12. Q: What kind of sports are popular in your country?

A: In Azerbaijan, popular sports include football, wrestling, and chess.

13. Q: What are some exercises you do to improve your strength?

A: Some exercises I do to improve my strength include weightlifting, push-ups, and squats.

14. Q: How do you feel after a good workout?

A: After a good workout, I feel rejuvenated and accomplished.

15. Q: How can sports teach us about life?

A: Sports can teach us about teamwork, perseverance, discipline, and the importance of maintaining physical and mental health.

16. Q: Have you ever been injured while playing sports?

A: Thankfully, I've never had a serious injury from playing sports, but I've had minor sprains and strains.

17. Q: Do you enjoy watching sports on television?

A: Yes, I enjoy watching sports on television. It's exciting and I can learn a lot from the strategies and techniques the athletes use.

18. Q: Why is warming up important before exercising?

A: Warming up is important as it prepares the body for physical activity by increasing heart rate and circulation, which warms up the muscles and joints, and prevents injuries.

19. Q: How does playing sports affect our mental health?

A: Playing sports can have a positive impact on mental health by reducing stress, improving mood, and boosting self-confidence.

20. Q: Do you think children should be encouraged to participate in sports from a young age?

A: Yes, I believe children should be encouraged to participate in sports from a young age as it promotes physical health, teaches teamwork, and builds confidence.

Lesson 16: Housing and Neighborhood

New Words and Definitions:

1. House: A building for human habitation, especially one that consists of a ground floor and one or more upper storeys.
2. Apartment: A suite of rooms forming one residence, typically in a building containing a number of these.
3. Neighborhood: A district or community within a town or city.
4. Furnished: Provided with furniture and fittings.
5. Unfurnished: Not provided with furniture and fittings.
6. Rent: A tenant's regular payment to a landlord for the use of property or land.
7. Lease: A contract by which one party conveys land, property, services, etc. to another for a specified time, usually in return for a periodic payment.
8. Property: A thing or things belonging to someone; possessions collectively.
9. Residential: Designed for people to live in.
10. Commercial: Making or intended to make a profit.
11. Garden: A piece of ground, often near a house, used for growing flowers, fruit, or vegetables.
12. Garage: A building or indoor area for parking or storing motor vehicles.
13. Balcony: A platform enclosed by a wall or balustrade on the outside of a building, with access from an upper-floor window or door.
14. Basement: The floor of a building which is partly or entirely below ground level.
15. Attic: A space or room just below the roof of a house, often used for storing things.
16. Landlord: A person who rents land, a building, or an apartment to a tenant.
17. Tenant: A person who occupies land or property rented from a landlord.
18. Neighbor: A person living next door to or very near to the speaker or person referred to.
19. Noise: A sound, especially one that is loud or unpleasant or that causes disturbance.
20. Quiet: Making little or no noise.

Questions and Sample Answers:

1. Q: Can you describe your house/apartment?

A: I live in a medium-sized apartment with two bedrooms, a living room, a kitchen, and a bathroom. It's quite cozy and comfortable.

2. Q: What's your neighborhood like?

A: My neighborhood is quite peaceful and clean. There are a lot of trees and parks around, and it's safe to walk even late at night.

3. Q: What do you like about your current home?

A: I love that my home is near the city center but still quiet and peaceful. It's also close to various amenities like supermarkets and a gym.

4. Q: Is there anything you would like to change about your home or neighborhood?

A: I wish there was a playground or a park for children in my neighborhood. It would be a great place for kids to play and adults to relax.

5. Q: What does your dream house look like?

A: My dream house would be a spacious villa with a beautiful garden and a pool. It would have large windows to let in lots of natural light, and it would be located near the beach.

6. Q: Do you prefer living in a house or an apartment?

A: I prefer living in an apartment because it's more convenient and often closer to the city center.

7. Q: What are some important factors to consider when choosing a place to live?

A: Some important factors to consider are the location, the size and layout of the home, the price, the quality of the neighborhood, and proximity to amenities like schools, shops, and parks.

8. Q: How long have you lived in your current home?

A: I have lived in my current home for about five years.

9. Q: Do you get along with your neighbors?

A: Yes, I have good relationships with my neighbors. We often help each other out and sometimes have gatherings.

10. Q: Would you like to move to a different place in the future? Why or why not?

A: I would like to move to a place with a bigger garden in the future because I love gardening and would like to have more space to plant flowers and vegetables.

11. Q: Is your home close to your workplace or school?

A: Yes, my home is just a ten-minute drive from my workplace, which is very convenient.

12. Q: Do you rent or own your home?

A: I currently rent my apartment.

13. Q: Have you ever had any problems with your landlord or a neighbor?

A: Fortunately, I've never had any serious problems with my landlord or neighbors.

14. Q: What makes a neighborhood good or bad?

A: A good neighborhood is safe, clean, and quiet with friendly residents and good facilities. A bad neighborhood, on the other hand, may have high crime rates, noise, pollution, and unfriendly residents.

15. Q: How important is it for you to have a good relationship with your neighbors?

A: It's very important to have a good relationship with neighbors because we live in close proximity and can help each other in times of need.

16. Q: Do you have a favorite room in your house?

A: Yes, my favorite room is the living room because it's where I relax, watch TV, and spend time with my family.

17. Q: Is it common for people in your country to live in apartments or houses?

A: In Azerbaijan, it's common for people in the cities to live in apartments while those in rural areas often live in houses.

18. Q: What's the most expensive part of owning a home in your country?

A: The most expensive part of owning a home in Azerbaijan is probably the cost of maintenance and repairs, especially for older properties.

19. Q: How often do people in your country move houses?

A: In Azerbaijan, people generally don't move houses very often unless they need to because of work or family reasons.

20. Q: What are the benefits and drawbacks of living in a big house?

A: The benefits of living in a big house include having more space, privacy, and potentially a garden. The drawbacks can include higher costs for purchase, maintenance, and utilities, and it can also be more time-consuming to clean and manage.

Lesson 17: Music and Entertainment

New Words and Definitions:

1. Music: Vocal or instrumental sounds (or both) combined in such a way as to produce beauty of form, harmony, and expression of emotion.
2. Genre: A style or category of art, music, or literature.
3. Band: A group of musicians who play music together.
4. Movie: A story or event recorded by a camera as a set of moving images and shown in a theater or on television; a motion picture.
5. Entertainment: Things such as films, television, performances, etc. that are designed to amuse or entertain people.
6. Concert: A public performance of music.
7. Album: A collection of recordings issued as a single item on CD, record, or another medium.
8. Lyrics: The words of a song.
9. Director: A person who is in charge of a film or play and tells the actors how to play their parts.
10. Actor: A person whose profession is acting on the stage, in films, or on television.
11. Screen: The area of a television or computer monitor where the images and information appear.
12. Stage: A raised floor or platform, typically in a theater, on which actors, entertainers, or speakers perform.
13. Audience: The assembled spectators or listeners at a public event, such as a play, movie, concert, or meeting.
14. Comedy: Professional entertainment consisting of jokes and sketches, intended to make an audience laugh.
15. Drama: A play for theater, radio, or television.
16. Thriller: A novel, play, or movie with an exciting plot, typically involving crime or political intrigue.
17. Pop music: A genre of popular music that originated in its modern form during the mid-1950s in the United States and the United Kingdom.

18. Rock music: A genre of popular music that originated as "rock and roll" in the United States in the early 1950s, and developed into a range of different styles in the 1960s and later.

19. Classical music: Art music produced or rooted in the traditions of Western culture, including both liturgical (religious) and secular music.

20. Jazz: A genre of music that originated in the African-American communities of New Orleans, United States, in the late 19th and early 20th centuries, with roots in blues and ragtime.

Questions and Sample Answers:

1. Q: What kind of music do you like?

A: I enjoy listening to pop music, but I also like jazz and classical music.

2. Q: Do you have a favorite band or artist?

A: Yes, I love listening to Coldplay. Their songs are very meaningful and catchy.

3. Q: Have you ever been to a concert?

A: Yes, I've been to a few concerts. The most memorable one was a live performance by my favorite band.

4. Q: What role does music play in your life?

A: Music plays a significant role in my life. It helps me relax, uplifts my mood, and sometimes, it even helps me concentrate while studying.

5. Q: What kind of movies do you like to watch?

A: I enjoy watching comedies because they make me laugh and feel good. But I also like thrillers for their suspense.

6. Q: Do you have a favorite actor or director?

A: Yes, my favorite actor is Tom Hanks, and my favorite director is Christopher Nolan. I find their works very impressive.

7. Q: How often do you go to the cinema?

A: I go to the cinema once or twice a month, usually with friends or family.

8. Q: How does watching movies or listening to music make you feel?

A: Watching movies and listening to music gives me joy and relaxation. It's a great way to unwind after a long day.

9. Q: Have you ever acted in a play or performed on stage?

A: No, I've never acted in a play, but I've performed on stage during school events.

10. Q: Who is your favorite character from a movie or a book?

A: My favorite character is Hermione Granger from the Harry Potter series because she is smart, brave, and loyal.

11. Q: What's your favorite song and why?

A: My favorite song is "Viva la Vida" by Coldplay. I love the melody, and the lyrics are very inspiring.

12. Q: How do you feel about reality TV shows?

A: I think reality TV shows can be entertaining, but I don't take them too seriously.

13. Q: Do you prefer watching movies at home or in the cinema?

A: I prefer watching movies in the cinema for the big screen experience, but watching at home is more convenient and comfortable.

14. Q: What was the last concert you attended?

A: The last concert I attended was a performance by a local jazz band. It was a wonderful experience.

15. Q: Do you prefer listening to music alone or with others?

A: I enjoy both. Listening to music alone allows me to relax, while listening with others can be a fun social activity.

16. Q: Have you ever taken music lessons?

A: Yes, I took piano lessons when I was younger.

17. Q: Do you play any musical instruments?

A: Yes, I can play the piano and the guitar.

18. Q: What's your favorite film of all time?

A: My favorite film is "The Shawshank Redemption". I think it's a masterpiece.

19. Q: Can you recommend a good movie or music album?

A: I'd recommend the movie "Inception" for its unique plot and brilliant performances. As for music, I'd suggest "A Rush of Blood to the Head" by Coldplay.

20. Q: How important is entertainment in your life?

A: Entertainment is quite important to me. It helps me relax, de-stress, and enjoy life more.

Lesson 18: Culture and Traditions

New Words and Definitions:

1. Culture: The arts and other manifestations of human intellectual achievement regarded collectively.
2. Tradition: The transmission of customs or beliefs from generation to generation, or the fact of being passed on in this way.
3. Heritage: Valued objects and qualities such as cultural traditions, unspoiled countryside, and historic buildings that have been passed down from previous generations.
4. Custom: A traditional and widely accepted way of behaving or doing something that is specific to a particular society, place, or time.
5. Festival: A day or period of celebration, typically for religious reasons.
6. Cuisine: A style or method of cooking, especially as characteristic of a particular country, region, or establishment.
7. Clothing: Clothes collectively.
8. Diversity: The state of being diverse; variety.
9. Novruz: The traditional Azerbaijani New Year holiday, celebrated with a variety of customs and rituals.
10. Carpets: Azerbaijan is famous for its traditional carpets, which are often handwoven and feature intricate designs.
11. Tea culture: The cultural aspects surrounding the drinking of tea, which is an important part of Azerbaijani hospitality.
12. Comparison: The act or instance of comparing.
13. Similarity: The state or fact of being similar.
14. Difference: A point or way in which people or things are dissimilar.

Questions and Sample Answers:

1. Q: Can you describe some traditional Azerbaijani customs?

A: In Azerbaijan, we have a rich culture and many traditions. For instance, tea drinking is an integral part of our hospitality. We also celebrate Novruz, which is our traditional New Year holiday.

2. Q: What are some traditional Azerbaijani foods?

A: Azerbaijan is known for its diverse cuisine. Some traditional dishes include plov, which is a rice dish with various ingredients, and kebabs made from mutton or chicken.

3. Q: What traditional clothes do people wear in Azerbaijan?

A: Traditional Azerbaijani clothing includes the Chokha for men, which is a coat usually worn with a belt, and for women, the national costume is a long dress made of colorful fabrics often decorated with intricate embroideries.

4. Q: Can you tell me about a traditional Azerbaijani festival or celebration?

A: Novruz is one of the most important festivals in Azerbaijan. It marks the beginning of spring and is celebrated with various customs and rituals, including spring cleaning, planting trees, and making traditional foods.

5. Q: What are some cultural differences between Azerbaijan and English-speaking countries?

A: There are many differences, but one that stands out is the approach to hospitality. In Azerbaijan, guests are treated with immense respect and generosity, often being offered the best food and drink in the house. In many English-speaking countries, hospitality is also valued, but the practices can be less formal.

6. Q: Can you describe a unique aspect of Azerbaijani culture?

A: Carpet weaving is a unique aspect of Azerbaijani culture. These handwoven carpets, known for their intricate designs and high quality, are a symbol of our national heritage.

7. Q: What is a common cultural practice in Azerbaijan?

A: One common cultural practice is the drinking of tea, often served in a traditional glass called an armudu. This is usually accompanied by sweet pastries or fruit preserves.

8. Q: What are some similarities between Azerbaijani and English-speaking cultures?

A: While there are many differences, there are also similarities. For example, both cultures value education highly and have a strong literary tradition.

9. Q: Can you tell me about the music in Azerbaijan?

A: Azerbaijani music is a rich blend of traditional and modern styles. The country is known for its mugham music, a traditional genre that is often improvised and complex. We also have a thriving pop and hip-hop scene.

10. Q: What is something you would like people from English-speaking countries to know about Azerbaijani culture?

A: I would like them to know about our deep-rooted traditions, our delicious cuisine, and our renowned hospitality. I'd also like to invite them to experience our festivals like Novruz, which is full of joy and celebration.

11. Q: How do Azerbaijani traditions reflect the country's history?

A: Azerbaijani traditions often reflect our rich history and cultural diversity. For instance, our traditional music, dance, and cuisine are influenced by the various cultures that have interacted with Azerbaijan throughout history.

12. Q: How has Azerbaijani culture influenced your life?

A: Azerbaijani culture has greatly influenced my life. It has instilled in me a sense of hospitality, a love for our traditional music and food, and a deep respect for our customs and traditions.

13. Q: What are some traditional Azerbaijani arts and crafts?

A: Besides carpet weaving, other traditional Azerbaijani arts and crafts include pottery, metalwork, and embroidery. These crafts often feature motifs inspired by nature and Azerbaijani mythology.

14. Q: How is family life in Azerbaijan?

A: Family life is very important in Azerbaijan. Families often live close to each other and it's common to have extended family gatherings, especially on holidays and special occasions.

15. Q: How is the Azerbaijani language different from English?

A: Azerbaijani and English belong to different language families, so they have different grammar, vocabulary, and sounds. Azerbaijani uses a variant of the Latin alphabet, similar to English, but it has some additional letters.

16. Q: What kind of literature is popular in Azerbaijan?

A: Both traditional and modern literature are popular in Azerbaijan. We have a strong tradition of poetry, with poets like Nizami Ganjavi and Samad Vurgun being widely read. Contemporary novels and short stories are also popular.

17. Q: How are weddings celebrated in Azerbaijan?

A: Weddings in Azerbaijan are grand events, often with hundreds of guests. They typically involve several stages, including the engagement, the henna night for the bride, and the actual wedding ceremony, which is full of music, dance, and feasting.

18. Q: How do Azerbaijani people celebrate the New Year?

A: Besides the Gregorian New Year, Azerbaijanis celebrate Novruz, which marks the Persian New Year and the beginning of spring. It's a festive time with lots of traditional food, family gatherings, and public celebrations.

19. Q: Can you tell me more about Azerbaijani hospitality?

A: Azerbaijani hospitality is known for its warmth and generosity. Guests are treated with great respect and are often offered the best of everything, including food, drink, and accommodation.

20. Q: How do the different regions of Azerbaijan differ culturally?

A: Different regions of Azerbaijan have their unique traditions, dialects, and cuisines. For instance, the city of Sheki is famous for its unique architecture and its specialty dish, piti, while the Guba region is known for its carpets and apple orchards.

Lesson 19: Environment and Nature

New Words and Definitions:

1. Environment: The natural world, as a whole or in a particular geographical area, especially as affected by human activity.
2. Nature: The phenomena of the physical world collectively, including plants, animals, the landscape, and other features and products of the earth.
3. Conservation: The preservation, protection, or restoration of the natural environment and of wildlife.
4. Pollution: The presence in or introduction into the environment of contaminants or substances that have harmful or poisonous effects.
5. Climate change: A long-term change in the earth's climate, especially a change due to an increase in the average atmospheric temperature.
6. Ecosystem: A biological community of interacting organisms and their physical environment.
7. Wildlife: Wild animals collectively; the native fauna (and sometimes flora) of a region.
8. Landscape: All the visible features of an area of countryside or land, often considered in terms of their aesthetic appeal.
9. Forest: A large area covered chiefly with trees and undergrowth.
10. Mountain: A large natural elevation of the earth's surface rising abruptly from the surrounding level; a large steep hill.
11. Ocean: The vast body of salt water that covers almost three-quarters of the earth's surface.
12. River: A large natural stream of water flowing in a channel to the sea, a lake, or another river.
13. Recycling: Convert (waste) into reusable material.
14. Sustainability: The ability to be maintained at a certain rate or level.
15. Renewable energy: Energy from a source that is not depleted when used, such as wind or solar power.

Questions and Sample Answers:

1. Q: Can you describe some natural landscapes in Azerbaijan?

A: Azerbaijan is home to a diverse range of natural landscapes. We have the lush greenery of the Caucasus Mountains, the beaches and warm waters of the Caspian Sea, and the semi-desert plains in the central region.

2. Q: What are some common environmental issues in your country?

A: Like many countries, Azerbaijan faces environmental challenges such as pollution, deforestation, and the impact of climate change. There are also issues related to the exploitation of natural resources.

3. Q: What can we do to protect the environment?

A: There are many ways to protect the environment. We can conserve water, reduce, reuse and recycle waste, and use renewable sources of energy. We can also support conservation efforts and promote sustainable practices in our communities.

4. Q: How does climate change affect Azerbaijan?

A: Climate change poses several threats to Azerbaijan. It can lead to rising sea levels, which can cause coastal flooding. It can also alter weather patterns, causing more extreme weather events and impacting agriculture.

5. Q: Can you tell me about a unique animal or plant species in Azerbaijan?

A: The Caucasian leopard, also known as the Persian leopard, is a unique animal species found in Azerbaijan. It's currently endangered due to habitat loss and hunting. In terms of plants, the ironwood tree is a symbol of strength in Azerbaijani culture and is protected by the government.

6. Q: What steps do you take personally to protect the environment?

A: I try to do my part by recycling, conserving water, and reducing my use of plastics. I also try to use public transport or carpooling to reduce my carbon footprint.

7. Q: How does pollution affect the environment?

A: Pollution can have severe effects on the environment. It can contaminate our air, water, and soil, harming wildlife and affecting biodiversity. It can also contribute to climate change and have harmful effects on human health.

8. Q: What is your favorite type of natural landscape and why?

A: I love the mountains because of their majestic beauty and tranquility. They remind me of the power and grandeur of nature.

9. Q: What is sustainability and why is it important?

A: Sustainability is about meeting our needs without compromising the ability of future generations to meet theirs. It's important because it ensures the long-term health of our planet and its ecosystems.

10. Q: What is renewable energy and can you give some examples?

A: Renewable energy comes from resources that can be naturally replenished, like sunlight, wind, rain, tides, and geothermal heat. Examples include solar power, wind energy, and hydroelectric power.

11. Q: How does deforestation impact the environment?

A: Deforestation can have significant impacts on the environment. It can lead to loss of biodiversity, disrupt ecosystems, and contribute to climate change by reducing the amount of carbon dioxide that forests can absorb.

12. Q: What are some ways to conserve water?

A: Some ways to conserve water include taking shorter showers, fixing leaks, using water-efficient appliances, and watering plants during the cooler parts of the day to reduce evaporation.

13. Q: What are some animals you can find in Azerbaijan's forests?

A: Azerbaijan's forests are home to a variety of wildlife, including brown bears, wolves, wild boars, and various bird species. The endangered Caucasian leopard can also be found in some regions.

14. Q: How can recycling benefit the environment?

A: Recycling can reduce the amount of waste that ends up in landfills and oceans. It can also save resources, reduce pollution, and lower greenhouse gas emissions.

15. Q: Why is it important to protect wildlife?

A: Protecting wildlife is crucial for maintaining biodiversity and healthy ecosystems. Many species play important roles in their environments, such as pollination, seed dispersal, and nutrient cycling.

16. Q: Can you tell me about a national park or protected area in Azerbaijan?

A: Gobustan National Park, located west of the capital Baku, is a UNESCO World Heritage site. It's known for its rocky landscape, ancient carvings, and mud volcanoes.

17. Q: What do you think about the use of plastic and its impact on the environment?

A: The use of plastic is a significant environmental issue. It's non-biodegradable and can pollute land and water bodies, harm wildlife, and contribute to climate change. It's essential to reduce our plastic use and find sustainable alternatives.

18. Q: How do natural disasters impact the environment?

A: Natural disasters can cause significant damage to the environment. They can destroy habitats, cause loss of biodiversity, and disrupt ecosystems. Recovery from such events can take a long time.

19. Q: What role do individuals play in environmental conservation?

A: Individuals play a vital role in environmental conservation. Our everyday choices, from the products we buy to the way we dispose of our waste, can have a big impact on the environment. By making environmentally friendly choices, we can help protect our planet.

20. Q: What are some of the most beautiful natural landmarks in Azerbaijan?

A: Azerbaijan boasts a variety of beautiful natural landmarks. Gobustan National Park with its petroglyphs and mud volcanoes is a popular attraction. The stunning landscapes of the Caucasus Mountains, especially around the region of Khinalig, are must-sees. The Caspian Sea coastline also offers many beautiful spots. And, let's not forget about Lake Goygol, often described as the most beautiful lake in the country.

Lesson 20: Fashion and Style

New Words and Definitions:

1. Fashion: A popular or the latest style of clothing, hair, decoration, or behavior.
2. Style: A particular, distinctive, or characteristic mode of action or manner of acting.
3. Trend: A general direction in which something is developing or changing.
4. Designer: A person who plans the look or workings of something prior to it being made, by preparing drawings or plans.
5. Outfit: A set of clothes worn together, typically for a particular occasion or purpose.
6. Accessory: A thing that can be added to something else in order to make it more useful, versatile, or attractive.
7. Wardrobe: A person's entire collection of clothes.
8. Casual: Relaxed and unconcerned; not regular or permanent.
9. Formal: Done in accordance with rules of convention or etiquette; suitable for or constituting an official or important occasion.
10. Vintage: Denoting something from the past of high quality, especially something representing the best of its kind.
11. Tailor: A person whose occupation is making or altering outer garments.
12. Boutique: A small store selling fashionable clothes or accessories.
13. Fashionable: Characteristic of, influenced by, or representing a current popular style.
14. Haute couture: High-end fashion that is constructed by hand from start to finish, made from high-quality, expensive, often unusual fabric and sewn with extreme attention to detail and finished by the most experienced and capable of sewers.
15. Runway: A narrow platform extending from a stage on which people walk, especially used by models displaying clothes.
16. Fashion week: A fashion industry event, lasting approximately one week, where fashion designers, brands or "houses" display their latest collections in runway fashion shows to buyers and the media.
17. Trendsetter: A person who leads the way in fashion or ideas.
18. Chic: Elegantly and stylishly fashionable.

19. Retro: Imitative of a style, fashion, or design from the recent past.

20. Thrift shopping: The act of shopping at a thrift store, flea market, garage sale, or a shop of a charitable organization, usually with the intent of finding interesting items at a low price.

Questions and Sample Answers:

1. Q: Can you describe your personal style?

A: I would describe my personal style as casual and comfortable. I like wearing simple pieces like jeans and t-shirts, and I usually stick to neutral colors.

2. Q: What are some popular fashion trends in Azerbaijan right now?

A: Some current fashion trends in Azerbaijan include a mix of traditional and modern styles. People love to wear national clothes especially on occasions. Also, oversized clothing and earth tones are quite popular among young people.

3. Q: Who is your favorite fashion designer and why?

A: I really admire the work of Aygun Aliyeva, a local designer. She creates a beautiful blend of modern fashion with Azerbaijani traditional motifs. I think her designs are unique and elegant.

4. Q: How do you decide what to wear each day?

A: I usually choose my outfits based on my plans for the day. If I'm going to university, I opt for something comfortable and casual. If I'm going out with friends, I might dress up a little more.

5. Q: Can you describe the last outfit you bought?

A: The last outfit I bought was a cute summer dress. It's a lovely shade of blue, and it has a floral pattern. I thought it was perfect for the warm weather.

6. Q: How does fashion impact society?

A: Fashion can have a significant impact on society. It's a form of self-expression and a way for people to showcase their individuality. It can also reflect cultural trends and societal values.

7. Q: Do you follow fashion trends, or do you prefer to dress in your own unique style?

A: While I like to keep up with current trends, I always try to incorporate my personal style into my outfits. I believe it's important to wear what makes you feel comfortable and confident.

8. Q: Have you ever attended a fashion show? Can you describe the experience?

A: I have not attended a fashion show yet, but I would love to. I imagine it would be a very exciting and inspiring experience to see the latest designs and trends on the runway.

9. Q: What role do accessories play in your outfits?

A: Accessories are an essential part of my outfits. They can add a touch of personality and complete the look. I particularly like wearing scarves and statement jewelry.

10. Q: What do you think about the influence of celebrities on fashion trends?

A: Celebrities can have a big influence on fashion trends. Many people look to celebrities for style inspiration, and what they wear can quickly become popular. However, I think it's also important to develop your own sense of style.

11. Q: How often do you go shopping for clothes?

A: I usually go shopping for clothes once every few months. I prefer to invest in a few quality pieces rather than constantly updating my wardrobe.

12. Q: Can you describe a traditional Azerbaijani outfit?

A: A traditional Azerbaijani outfit for women typically includes a long, flowing dress called a 'chokha' with intricate embroidery, paired with a headscarf. Men's traditional clothing also includes a version of the chokha, often worn with a woolen hat.

13. Q: Do you think fashion is important? Why or why not?

A: Yes, I think fashion is important because it allows us to express ourselves and our personalities. It's also a form of art and creativity, and it can reflect the culture and values of a society.

14. Q: Have you ever tried to make or alter your own clothes?

A: Yes, I have tried to alter my own clothes a few times. It's a great way to give new life to old pieces and create a custom fit.

15. Q: What do you think about vintage fashion?

A: I love vintage fashion. I think older styles can be very elegant and unique. Plus, shopping for vintage clothes can be a fun way to explore fashion history.

16. Q: What would be your dream outfit?

A: My dream outfit would be a comfortable but elegant dress from a high-end designer, paired with simple but stylish accessories. I would love to wear something like this to a special event.

17. Q: Do you have any favorite fashion boutiques or stores in Azerbaijan?

A: Yes, I have a few favorite boutiques in Baku, the capital of Azerbaijan. I really like "Emporium" for trendy pieces and "Chirag" for more traditional Azerbaijani clothes.

18. Q: What is your opinion on thrift shopping?

A: I think thrift shopping is a great way to find unique and affordable pieces. It's also a more sustainable option than buying new clothes.

19. Q: What kind of clothes do you wear when you want to feel comfortable?

A: When I want to feel comfortable, I usually wear loose-fitting clothes like a pair of joggers and a cozy sweater. I also love wearing sneakers for comfort.

20. Q: How has Azerbaijani fashion changed over the years?

A: Azerbaijani fashion has evolved significantly over the years. While traditional clothing is still worn for special occasions, western styles are now commonly seen in everyday life. There's also a growing fashion industry in Azerbaijan, with local designers gaining recognition both locally and internationally.

Lesson 21: Technology and Internet

New Words and Definitions:

1. Technology: Machinery and devices developed from scientific knowledge.
2. Internet: A global computer network providing a variety of information and communication facilities.
3. Smartphone: A mobile phone that performs many of the functions of a computer.
4. Application (App): A program or piece of software designed and written to fulfill a particular purpose of the user.
5. Social Media: Websites and applications that enable users to create and share content or to participate in social networking.
6. Cybersecurity: The state of being protected against the criminal or unauthorized use of electronic data.
7. Online Shopping: The activity of buying products or services over the Internet.
8. E-learning: Learning conducted via electronic media, typically on the internet.
9. Artificial Intelligence (AI): The capability of a machine to imitate intelligent human behavior.
10. Virtual Reality (VR): The computer-generated simulation of a three-dimensional image or environment.
11. Blog: A regularly updated website or web page, typically one run by an individual or small group, that is written in an informal or conversational style.
12. Gadget: A small mechanical or electronic device or tool.
13. Download: To transfer (software, data, character sets, etc.) from a distant to a nearby computer.
14. Upload: Transfer (data) from one computer to another, typically to one that is larger or remote from the user or functioning as a server.
15. Wi-Fi: A facility allowing computers, smartphones, or other devices to connect to the Internet or communicate with one another wirelessly within a particular area.
16. Digital: Involving or relating to the use of computer technology.
17. Screen Time: The time spent using a device such as a computer, television, or games console.

18. Device: A thing made or adapted for a particular purpose, especially a piece of mechanical or electronic equipment.

19. Software: The programs and other operating information used by a computer.

20. Hardware: The machines, wiring, and other physical components of a computer or other electronic system.

Questions and Sample Answers:

1. Q: Can you describe the role of technology in your daily life?

A: Technology plays a significant role in my daily life. I use my smartphone for communication, for studying, and for entertainment. I also use my laptop for schoolwork and research.

2. Q: What are some of the advantages of the internet?

A: The internet has numerous advantages. It provides access to a vast amount of information and resources. It also facilitates communication and allows for easy sharing of information across the globe.

3. Q: What are some disadvantages of the internet?

A: While the internet has many benefits, it also has some disadvantages. These include issues like cyberbullying, privacy concerns, and the spread of misinformation.

4. Q: What is your favorite smartphone app and why?

A: My favorite smartphone app is Duolingo. I use it to practice English and other languages. It's interactive and makes learning fun.

5. Q: How has technology changed the way we communicate?

A: Technology has revolutionized communication. With apps and social media platforms, we can instantly connect with people from all over the world.

6. Q: Can you talk about a recent technological advancement that you find fascinating?

A: One recent technological advancement I find fascinating is the development of virtual reality. It has the potential to change the way we interact with digital content.

7. Q: How often do you use social media? What platforms do you use most often?

A: I use social media every day. The platforms I use most often are Instagram and Facebook.

8. Q: Do you do a lot of online shopping? Why or why not?

A: Yes, I do a lot of online shopping because it's convenient. I can compare prices and read reviews before making a purchase.

9. Q: What measures do you take to ensure your cybersecurity?

A: To ensure my cybersecurity, I regularly update my devices, use strong and unique passwords, and I am careful about the information I share online.

10. Q: How has technology impacted education in your opinion?

A: Technology has greatly impacted education. With e-learning platforms, students can learn at their own pace and have access to a wide range of resources.

11. Q: Have you ever tried virtual reality? What was the experience like?

A: I have not yet tried virtual reality, but I'm very interested in experiencing it. I think it would be a unique and immersive experience.

12. Q: Do you follow any blogs or vlogs? Which ones and why?

A: Yes, I follow a few blogs, mainly about fashion and lifestyle. I enjoy seeing the creative content and getting inspiration from different bloggers.

13. Q: What is your opinion about the increasing screen time in today's digital age?

A: I think increasing screen time is a concern, especially for young people. It's important to balance time spent on devices with physical activity and face-to-face social interactions.

14. Q: How often do you download or upload files or apps?

A: I download apps or files occasionally, usually when I need a new tool for work or school. I also upload files when sharing documents or photos with others.

15. Q: Do you use Wi-Fi or mobile data more often? Why?

A: I tend to use Wi-Fi more often because it's typically faster and does not use up my mobile data allowance.

16. Q: What is the role of artificial intelligence (AI) in our daily lives?

A: AI plays a significant role in our lives today, from recommendation algorithms in streaming services to voice assistants on our phones. It's becoming more and more integrated into our everyday tasks.

17. Q: What precautions do you take to reduce the negative effects of excessive screen time?

A: I try to limit my screen time by taking regular breaks, using blue light filters, and dedicating specific hours to no-screen activities.

18. Q: What type of device do you use most often and why?

A: I use my smartphone most often because it's portable and versatile. I can use it for communication, entertainment, and work.

19. Q: Can you describe the difference between software and hardware?

A: Software refers to the programs and data that make our devices run, like operating systems and apps. Hardware refers to the physical components of a device, like the processor, memory, and display.

20. Q: How has the use of technology affected societal norms and behavior?

A: Technology has significantly affected societal norms and behavior. For instance, it's reshaped the way we communicate, the way we work, and even our consumption patterns with the rise of online shopping.

21. Q: Do you believe the advantages of technological advancement outweigh the disadvantages? Why or why not?

A: In my opinion, the advantages do outweigh the disadvantages. While there are concerns about privacy, cybercrime, and the impact on mental health, the benefits in terms of communication, access to information, and efficiency are immense.

22. Q: What technological advancement do you anticipate in the next decade?

A: In the next decade, I anticipate significant advancements in artificial intelligence and machine learning. I also expect to see more development in the fields of virtual reality and augmented reality.

23. Q: What is your favorite gadget and why?

A: My favorite gadget is my smartphone. It's versatile and allows me to perform a variety of tasks from anywhere, from communication to entertainment to work.

24. Q: Have you ever participated in an online course or e-learning program?

A: Yes, I've taken a few online courses to supplement my university studies. They allow me to learn at my own pace and explore topics outside of my major.

25. Q: How do you think the internet and technology will evolve in the future?

A: I think the internet and technology will continue to become more integrated into our daily lives. We'll likely see advancements in areas like artificial intelligence, virtual and augmented reality, and personalized learning. I also anticipate more emphasis on cybersecurity as our reliance on digital technologies increases.

Lesson 22: Books and Literature

New Words and Definitions:

1. Novel: A long story about people and events that are imagined by the writer.
2. Fiction: Stories that are made up, not true.
3. Non-fiction: Books about real facts and events.
4. Biography: A book about a person's life written by someone else.
5. Autobiography: A book a person writes about their own life.
6. Poetry: Words arranged in a special way to express feelings, often with rhyme.
7. Short story: A brief, imagined story.
8. Character: A person in a story.
9. Plot: The main events in a story.
10. Setting: Where and when a story happens.
11. Theme: The main idea or message of a story.
12. Author: The person who writes a book.
13. Genre: A type or category of book, like romance or mystery.
14. Series: A group of books that continue the same story or topic.
15. Trilogy: Three books that tell one complete story.
16. Publisher: The company that makes and sells the book.
17. Illustrations: Pictures in a book.
18. Protagonist: The main person in a story.
19. Antagonist: The person or thing against the protagonist in a story.
20. Narrative: The way a story is told.

Questions and Answers:

1. Q: What's your favorite genre of book?

A: My favorite genre is fiction because it allows me to explore different worlds and characters.

2. Q: Can you name a book you really enjoyed and explain why you liked it?

A: I really enjoyed reading "To Kill a Mockingbird" because of its exploration of themes like justice and morality through a child's perspective.

3. Q: Who is your favorite author and why?

A: My favorite author is J.K. Rowling because she created the Harry Potter series, which I love for its creativity and depth of characters.

4. Q: Have you ever read a biography or an autobiography? Whose was it and what did you learn from it?

A: Yes, I read Nelson Mandela's autobiography. It taught me about resilience, the fight for justice, and the importance of standing up for what you believe in.

5. Q: Do you prefer series or standalone books?

A: I prefer series because they allow me to spend more time with characters and really delve into the story.

6. Q: How often do you read?

A: I try to read every day, even if it's just for a few minutes before bed.

7. Q: Do you have a favorite place to read?

A: My favorite place to read is in my bedroom, where it's quiet and comfortable.

8. Q: Have you ever been part of a book club?

A: No, I haven't been part of a book club, but it's something I'd be interested in.

9. Q: What book are you currently reading?

A: I'm currently reading "1984" by George Orwell.

10. Q: Do you prefer traditional books or e-books?

A: I prefer traditional books because I enjoy the feel of the pages and like to take notes in the margins.

11. Q: Can you describe the plot of a book you've recently read?

A: I recently read "Animal Farm" by George Orwell. It's an allegory of the Russian Revolution, told through the story of animals rebelling against their human farmer.

12. Q: Who is your favorite character from a book and why?

A: My favorite character is Hermione Granger from the Harry Potter series because she's smart, brave, and always stands up for what she believes in.

13. Q: How has a book influenced or changed you?

A: Reading "To Kill a Mockingbird" made me more aware of social injustices and inspired me to be more empathetic and understanding.

14. Q: Have you ever read a book in a language other than your native one?

A: Yes, I have read several books in English to improve my language skills.

15. Q: What's your favorite classic book and why?

A: My favorite classic book is "Pride and Prejudice" by Jane Austen because of its strong characters and sharp social commentary.

16. Q: Do you prefer fiction or non-fiction? Why?

A: I prefer fiction because it offers an escape from reality and sparks my imagination.

17. Q: Can you recommend a book that you think everyone should read?

A: I would recommend "To Kill a Mockingbird" because of its powerful themes and memorable characters.

18. Q: Have you ever read a book based on a recommendation and ended up not liking it?

A: Yes, it has happened a few times. Everyone has different tastes, so a book that someone else loves might not resonate with me.

19. Q: Do you enjoy poetry? If so, who is your favorite poet?

A: Yes, I do enjoy poetry. My favorite poet is Emily Dickinson because her poems are thoughtful and beautifully written.

20. Q: How do you choose what book to read next?

A: I usually choose based on recommendations from friends or reviews I read online. I also consider what mood I'm in and what kind of story I'm in the mood for.

21. Q: Have you ever read a book that made you cry?

A: Yes, "The Fault in Our Stars" by John Green made me cry. It's a very emotional story.

22. Q: What is a book you didn't like and why?

A: I didn't like "Fifty Shades of Grey". I found the writing style to be weak and the characters uninteresting.

23. Q: Have you ever been so engrossed in a book that you lost track of time?

A: Absolutely! When I read the Harry Potter books for the first time, I was so absorbed that I would often read for hours without even realizing it.

24. Q: Have you ever re-read a book? Which one and why?

A: Yes, I've re-read the Harry Potter series several times. I always find something new to enjoy and appreciate in the story and characters.

25. Q: Have you ever read a book that was better than the movie?

A: Yes, in my opinion, the book "The Hobbit" by J.R.R. Tolkien was better than the movie adaptation. The book had more depth and detail.

Lesson 22: News and Media

New Words and Definitions:

1. Journalism: The work of collecting news for newspapers, TV, or radio.
2. Broadcast: To send out a program on television or radio.
3. Newspaper: A daily or weekly paper that has news, articles, and ads.
4. Magazine: A type of thin book with pictures and stories, published weekly or monthly.
5. Online media: News or stories on the internet, not on paper or TV.
6. Social media: Websites where people share and talk about personal information, photos, and videos.
7. Report: A written or spoken description of what happened.
8. Article: A piece of writing about a particular topic in a newspaper or magazine.
9. Headline: The title of a news story in a newspaper or on a news website.
10. Editor: The person who chooses what will be in a newspaper, magazine, or book.
11. Fake news: False stories that appear to be news, spread on the internet or using other media.
12. Fact-checking: Making sure that information is correct and true.
13. Bias: When stories favor one side more than the other.
14. Propaganda: Information used to make people think a certain way.
15. Censorship: When someone in authority, like a government, controls what can be said or published.
16. Podcast: A radio-like show that you can download from the internet.
17. Documentary: A film or TV program that tells the truth about a real topic.
18. Live stream: Watching video or listening to audio in real time on the internet.
19. Breaking news: Fresh news that is happening right now.
20. Correspondent: A journalist who reports news from a certain place or on a certain topic.

Questions and Answers:

1. Q: Where do you usually get your news from?

A: I usually get my news from various online platforms, including news websites and social media.

2. Q: Can you name a few reliable news sources?

A: Some reliable news sources are BBC, The New York Times, and Al Jazeera.

3. Q: Have you ever encountered "fake news"? How did you recognize it?

A: Yes, I have come across "fake news". I recognized it because the information seemed exaggerated and it wasn't reported by any credible news outlets.

4. Q: What do you think about the role of social media in news dissemination?

A: I think social media plays a significant role in spreading news quickly, but it can also lead to the rapid spread of misinformation.

5. Q: What's a recent news story that impacted you?

A: The recent news about climate change has greatly impacted me. It made me more aware of the urgent need for sustainable practices.

6. Q: What does the term 'media bias' mean to you?

A: 'Media bias' refers to when news outlets present information in a way that reflects certain prejudices or preferences.

7. Q: Have you ever listened to a podcast or watched a documentary to learn more about a news topic?

A: Yes, I often watch documentaries and listen to podcasts to gain a deeper understanding of various news topics.

8. Q: What are your thoughts on censorship in media?

A: I believe that while some level of control is necessary to avoid harmful content, excessive censorship can restrict freedom of speech and access to information.

9. Q: Can you name a news topic that you think needs more media attention?

A: I believe mental health needs more media attention because it is a critical issue that many people struggle with.

10. Q: How do you verify the information you receive from the news?

A: I usually verify the information by checking multiple sources and using fact-checking websites.

11. Q: Do you think that the media has a responsibility to report the truth?

A: Yes, I think the media has a crucial role in reporting the truth and providing accurate information to the public.

12. Q: How has the consumption of news changed with the advent of digital media?

A: Digital media has made news more accessible and immediate, but it has also increased the prevalence of misinformation and "fake news".

13. Q: Have you ever been affected personally by a news story? How?

A: Yes, the news about the global pandemic affected me personally as it brought many changes to my daily life and future plans.

14. Q: What role does journalism play in society, according to you?

A: Journalism plays a crucial role in informing the public, promoting transparency, and holding powerful entities accountable.

15. Q: What is your opinion on celebrity news and gossip?

A: While it can be entertaining, I believe too much emphasis on celebrity news can distract from more important issues.

16. Q: What are the effects of 24/7 news channels?

A: 24/7 news channels can keep us updated at all times, but they can also lead to information overload and anxiety.

17. Q: Have you noticed any differences in the way news is reported in different countries?

A: Yes, the way news is reported can vary significantly depending on the country's culture, political climate, and media regulations.

18. Q: What type of news interests you the most - local, national, or international?

A: I am interested in international news as it helps me understand global issues and perspectives.

19. Q: Have you ever shared a news article on social media?

A: Yes, I often share news articles on social media to inform my friends about important issues.

20. Q: How do you think the media influences public opinion?

A: The media can greatly influence public opinion by choosing what stories to cover, how to present them, and what angle to take.

21. Q: What are some problems you see in today's news reporting?

A: Some issues in today's news reporting include sensationalism, bias, and the spread of misinformation.

22. Q: What is "citizen journalism"?

A: "Citizen journalism" refers to when ordinary people, not professional journalists, gather and share news, often through social media.

23. Q: Why is freedom of the press important?

A: Freedom of the press is essential for a democratic society because it promotes transparency and helps hold those in power accountable.

24. Q: Have you ever wanted to work in the media or journalism? Why or why not?

A: Yes, I have considered a career in journalism as it would allow me to investigate issues I'm passionate about and share important stories.

25. Q: How do you feel when you are disconnected from the news?

A: When I'm disconnected from the news, I feel a bit out of touch, but it can also be a good break from the constant influx of information.

Lesson 25. Public Transport

New Words and Definitions:

1. Public Transport: Vehicles like buses or trains that everyone can use.
2. Bus: A large vehicle that carries people from one place to another on roads.
3. Tram: A vehicle that runs on tracks in the street and carries people.
4. Metro: A train system that runs under the ground in big cities.
5. Taxi: A car that drives people where they want to go for money.
6. Train: A long vehicle that runs on tracks and carries people or goods.
7. Station: A place where buses or trains stop to pick up or drop off people.
8. Timetable: A list of times when buses or trains arrive and leave.
9. Ticket: A paper or card that allows you to use the bus, train, or other transport.
10. Peak hours: The busiest times of the day when many people are traveling.
11. Passenger: A person who travels in a vehicle but isn't driving it.
12. Conductor: A person who checks tickets on a bus or train.
13. Delay: When something, like a bus or train, is late.
14. Route: The path or way that buses, trains, or other vehicles travel.
15. Commute: The daily journey between home and work.
16. Traffic jam: When there are too many cars on the road, and they move very slowly.
17. Fare: The money you pay to travel by bus, train, taxi, etc.
18. Bicycle: A vehicle with two wheels that a person rides by pedaling.
19. Pedestrian: A person who is walking, especially on streets or roads.
20. Crosswalk: A place on the road where pedestrians can safely cross.

Questions and Answers:

1. Q: What forms of public transport do you usually use?
A: I usually use the bus and metro for my daily commute.
2. Q: How often do you use public transport?
A: I use public transport every day to get to university and back home.

3. Q: What do you like about public transport?

A: I like that public transport is relatively cheap and it reduces the number of cars on the road, which is better for the environment.

4. Q: What do you dislike about public transport?

A: I dislike that public transport can be crowded, especially during peak hours, and sometimes it doesn't run on time.

5. Q: Do you think public transport is well-organized in your city?

A: Yes, I think it's well-organized. There's a good network of buses and the metro system covers most parts of the city.

6. Q: Have you ever experienced a significant delay or problem while using public transport?

A: Yes, once there was a technical problem with the metro, and I was stuck in the station for an hour.

7. Q: Do you prefer using public transport or private vehicles? Why?

A: I prefer public transport because it's more cost-effective and environmentally friendly.

8. Q: How can public transportation systems be improved, in your opinion?

A: Public transportation systems can be improved by adding more routes, increasing frequency during peak hours, and ensuring the vehicles are clean and comfortable.

9. Q: What's the most interesting or unusual experience you've had on public transport?

A: Once, a group of musicians started playing traditional music on the bus. It was an unexpected and enjoyable experience.

10. Q: What's your usual routine when you commute by public transport?

A: I usually read a book or listen to music to make the most of my travel time.

11. Q: Have you ever forgotten to buy a ticket for public transport? What happened?

A: No, I always make sure to buy a ticket because I know it's important to pay for the service.

12. Q: What role do you think bicycles and walking play in a city's transportation system?

A: Bicycles and walking play a crucial role in reducing traffic congestion and pollution. They're also healthy forms of transportation.

13. Q: Do you find the public transport fares in your city to be reasonable?

A: Yes, I think the fares are quite reasonable considering the convenience public transport offers.

14. Q: Have you ever taken a tram or a train? How was the experience?

A: Yes, I have taken a train for longer trips. It was a comfortable and enjoyable journey.

15. Q: How does rush hour traffic affect your daily commute?

A: Rush hour traffic can make the commute longer and more stressful due to overcrowding.

16. Q: How does the weather affect your use of public transport?

A: During rainy days, I prefer to use the metro to avoid getting wet.

17. Q: Have you ever used a taxi service? How do you compare it with public transport?

A: Yes, I have used a taxi service. It's more convenient and faster than public transport, but it's also more expensive.

18. Q: What precautions do you take while using public transport during the COVID-19 pandemic?

A: I always wear a mask, sanitize my hands regularly, and try to maintain social distancing as much as possible.

19. Q: How do you feel about people eating on public transport?

A: I think it's fine as long as they're not making a mess or disturbing other passengers.

20. Q: Do you prefer to stand or sit during your commute?

A: I prefer to sit during my commute, but I don't mind standing if there are no available seats.

21. Q: How do you pass the time during long journeys on public transport?

A: I usually read a book, listen to music or podcasts, or just look out the window and enjoy the scenery.

22. Q: Have you ever helped someone on public transport?

A: Yes, I have helped elderly people with their luggage and given up my seat for pregnant women.

23. Q: How does the use of public transport contribute to environmental conservation?

A: Public transport reduces the number of private vehicles on the road, which lowers carbon emissions and air pollution.

24. Q: Do you think the use of public transport should be promoted more? How?

A: Yes, it should be promoted by improving services, reducing fares, and creating awareness about its environmental benefits.

25. Q: Have you ever missed your stop while using public transport?

A: Yes, I have missed my stop a few times when I was too engrossed in a book or when the bus was too crowded.

Lesson 26. Free Time and Weekend Activities

New Words and Definitions:

1. Free Time: Time when you don't have to work or study and can do what you like.
2. Weekend: The two days at the end of the week, usually Saturday and Sunday.
3. Relax: To rest and not do anything stressful.
4. Work-life balance: Having a good amount of time for work and for personal activities.
5. Hobby: An activity you enjoy doing in your free time.
6. Leisure: Time when you are not working or studying and can relax.
7. Activities: Things you can do, especially for fun or relaxation.
8. Exercise: Physical activities to keep the body healthy.
9. Rest: To stop doing things and relax or sleep.
10. Party: A gathering of people to celebrate or have fun together.
11. Socialize: To spend time with other people for fun.
12. Outdoors: Outside, not in a building.
13. Indoors: Inside a building.
14. Entertainment: Things like music, movies, or shows that are made to amuse people.
15. Unwind: To relax and stop feeling tense or worried.
16. Catch up: To talk to someone you haven't seen for a while and find out what's new.
17. Volunteer: To do work without getting paid, often to help others.
18. Gardening: The activity of planting and taking care of plants in a garden.
19. Barbecue: A way of cooking food over an open fire, often outside.
20. Concert: A public performance of music.

Questions and Answers:

1. Q: What do you usually do in your free time?

A: In my free time, I usually read books or go for a walk in the park.

2. Q: What are your favorite weekend activities?

A: My favorite weekend activities include visiting friends, going to the cinema, and cooking.

3. Q: How important is it for you to have free time?

A: Having free time is very important to me. It helps me relax, recharge, and focus better when I get back to work or studies.

4. Q: How do you balance your work or studies with your free time?

A: I try to manage my time efficiently during the week so that I can have some free time during the weekend.

5. Q: Do you prefer spending your free time indoors or outdoors? Why?

A: I prefer spending my free time outdoors because I enjoy being in nature and it's a nice change from being indoors most of the time.

6. Q: What do you do when you have a whole day off with no obligations?

A: When I have a whole day off, I like to go on a day trip to a nearby city or spend the day exploring new places in my own city.

7. Q: Do you prefer to spend your free time alone or with others? Why?

A: I enjoy both. Sometimes, I need some alone time to relax and unwind, but I also enjoy spending time with friends and family.

8. Q: Do you think it's important to have hobbies? Why or why not?

A: Yes, I think it's important to have hobbies. They give you a chance to do something you enjoy, can relieve stress, and can also help you learn new skills.

9. Q: How often do you exercise in your free time?

A: I try to exercise at least three times a week. It helps me stay healthy and boosts my mood.

10. Q: Do you like to socialize in your free time? What do you usually do?

A: Yes, I enjoy socializing. I usually meet up with friends for coffee or go out to eat together.

11. Q: Have you ever volunteered in your free time? What did you do?

A: Yes, I have volunteered at a local animal shelter. I helped take care of the animals and assisted with their adoption events.

12. Q: What is your favorite way to relax and unwind?

A: My favorite way to relax is by reading a good book or watching a movie.

13. Q: How do you usually spend your weekends?

A: I usually spend my weekends catching up on rest, meeting up with friends, and pursuing my hobbies.

14. Q: Have you ever had a weekend trip? Where did you go?

A: Yes, I have had several weekend trips. I've visited different cities within my country and also some neighboring countries.

15. Q: How important is it to you to have a break on the weekend?

A: It's very important for me to have a break on the weekend. It gives me a chance to rest and prepare for the next week.

16. Q: Do you prefer active or relaxing weekends? Why?

A: I prefer a balance of both. I like to do some activities, but I also need time to relax.

17. Q: What is your favorite weekend memory?

A: My favorite weekend memory is a camping trip I took with my friends. We had a lot of fun hiking, cooking together, and sitting around the campfire.

18. Q: If you could do anything this weekend, what would you do?

A: If I could do anything, I would take a weekend trip to the seaside.

19. Q: What's the best way to spend a rainy weekend?

A: The best way to spend a rainy weekend is by staying in, reading a good book, watching movies, or playing board games.

20. Q: Do you think it's important to plan your free time or do you prefer to be spontaneous?

A: I think it's good to have a balance. Having a plan can help you make the most of your time, but being spontaneous can also lead to fun and unexpected experiences.

21. Q: Have you ever attended a concert or live event on the weekend? How was the experience?

A: Yes, I have attended a few concerts. It's always a great experience to see your favorite artists perform live.

22. Q: Do you do any gardening in your free time?

A: I don't have a garden at the moment, but I do have some indoor plants that I take care of.

23. Q: How important is it for people to disconnect from work during the weekend?

A: I think it's very important. Everyone needs time to rest and recharge in order to maintain their health and productivity.

24. Q: Have you ever organized a party or gathering in your free time?

A: Yes, I have organized a few birthday parties and casual gatherings with friends.

25. Q: What is something new you'd like to try in your free time?

A: I would like to try painting. It seems like a relaxing and creative way to spend time.

Lesson 27. History and Important Events

New Words and Definitions:

1. History: The study of past events.
2. Event: Something that happens, especially something important.
3. Century: A period of 100 years.
4. Ancient: From a very long time ago.
5. Medieval: Related to the Middle Ages, between ancient and modern times.
6. Modern: Of the present time or recent past.
7. Historical Figure: An important person from the past.
8. Independence: When a country becomes free from another country's control.
9. Revolution: A big change in the way a country is run.
10. War: A fight between countries or groups of people.
11. Peace: When there is no war or fighting.
12. Timeline: A line that shows the order in which events happened.
13. Empire: A group of countries or regions controlled by one ruler or government.
14. Discovery: Finding something or someone for the first time.
15. Colonization: When one country takes control of another place and settles there.
16. Decolonization: When a place becomes independent and free from the control of another country.
17. Industrialization: The process of developing industries in a country.
18. Globalization: When businesses and cultures from different places become connected and spread around the world.
19. Democracy: A system of government where people vote to make decisions.
20. Dictatorship: A government where one person or a small group has total power.
21. Monarchy: A system where a country is ruled by a king or queen.
22. Republic: A country without a king or queen, where people elect leaders.
23. Treaty: An official agreement between countries.
24. Alliance: An agreement between countries or groups to work together.
25. Artifact: An old object made by humans, often found by archaeologists.

Questions and Answers:

1. Q: Can you name a major historical event in Azerbaijan?

A: Yes, the declaration of independence from the Soviet Union in 1991 is a major historical event in Azerbaijan.

2. Q: Who is a famous historical figure from Azerbaijan?

A: A famous historical figure from Azerbaijan is Heydar Aliyev, who served as the President of Azerbaijan from 1993 to 2003.

3. Q: What is one significant world historical event that you know about?

A: One significant world historical event is the end of World War II in 1945, which marked the victory of the Allies and resulted in major geopolitical shifts.

4. Q: Can you explain what the term 'colonization' means?

A: Colonization is the process by which one country takes control over another area, establishing its own political, social, and economic systems there, often displacing the original population.

5. Q: Can you talk about a historical event from the ancient history of Azerbaijan?

A: The establishment of the ancient state of Caucasian Albania on the territory of Azerbaijan is one significant historical event.

6. Q: What is the 'Industrial Revolution'?

A: The Industrial Revolution was a period in the 18th and 19th centuries when major changes in agriculture, manufacturing, mining, and transport had a profound effect on the socioeconomic and cultural conditions in Britain, later spreading to Europe and the United States.

7. Q: Can you name a historical artifact from Azerbaijan?

A: The Gobustan Rock Art Cultural Landscape is a significant archaeological site in Azerbaijan featuring rock carvings dating back to 40,000 years ago.

8. Q: What was the impact of World War I on Azerbaijan?

A: World War I led to political instability in Azerbaijan, but also led to the eventual establishment of the Democratic Republic of Azerbaijan in 1918, which was the first democratic republic in the Muslim world.

9. Q: Who were the Safavids?

A: The Safavids were one of the most significant ruling dynasties of Iran, often considered the beginning of modern Iranian history. Azerbaijan was part of the Safavid state in the 15th to 18th centuries.

10. Q: What do you know about the history of Baku, the capital of Azerbaijan?

A: Baku has a rich history dating back to ancient times. It was an important city on the Silk Road and became a major oil-producing region in the 19th century. Today, it is a bustling modern city with both historical and modern landmarks.

11. Q: What was the impact of the discovery of oil in Azerbaijan?

A: The discovery of oil in the late 19th century transformed Azerbaijan economically, making Baku one of the world's leading oil producers by the early 20th century.

12. Q: How did Azerbaijan gain its independence?

A: Azerbaijan gained its independence after the dissolution of the Soviet Union in 1991.

13. Q: What is the role of history in shaping a nation's culture and identity?

A: History plays a critical role in shaping a nation's culture and identity as it reflects the experiences, struggles, and achievements of a people over time. It provides a sense of shared heritage and influences the nation's traditions, values, and social norms.

14. Q: Can you talk about a significant event in the history of democracy in the world?

A: A significant event in the history of democracy is the signing of the Magna Carta in 1215, which is often considered a cornerstone of liberty in the English-speaking world.

15. Q: Can you explain the term 'globalization' in a historical context?

A: In a historical context, globalization refers to the process by which countries and people around the world have become more interconnected and interdependent, often due to advancements in technology, trade, and cultural exchange.

16. Q: What do you know about the history of the Azerbaijani language?

A: The Azerbaijani language has a rich history, with its roots in the Turkic language family. It was influenced by Persian and Arabic due to historical interactions and has been written in different scripts including Arabic, Latin, and Cyrillic over different periods.

17. Q: How has the history of Azerbaijan influenced its current society and culture?

A: The history of Azerbaijan, with its rich cultural heritage, diverse influences, and historical events such as periods of foreign rule and independence, has significantly shaped its current society, culture, values, and national identity.

18. Q: Can you name a famous historical site in Azerbaijan?

A: The Palace of the Shirvanshahs, located in Baku, is a famous historical site in Azerbaijan. It was built during the 15th century by the Shirvanshah dynasty.

19. Q: Can you name a famous world historical figure?

A: A famous world historical figure is Martin Luther King Jr., who played a crucial role in the American civil rights movement in the 1950s and 1960s.

20. Q: What was a significant event in the history of human rights?

A: A significant event in the history of human rights is the adoption of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights by the United Nations General Assembly in 1948.

21. Q: How did the medieval period impact Azerbaijan?

A: The medieval period saw Azerbaijan as a region of conflict and exchange between different empires such as the Seljuks and Mongols, but it also saw periods of cultural and intellectual flowering, such as under the Safavids.

22. Q: What are some major historical events in the 20th century that had global impact?

A: Some major events in the 20th century with global

Lesson 28. Study Techniques and Tips

New Words and Definitions:

1. History: The study of things that happened in the past.
2. Event: Something that happens.
3. Century: A time period of 100 years.
4. Ancient: Very, very old.
5. Medieval: Related to the Middle Ages, a time between ancient and modern times.
6. Modern: About the present or recent times.
7. Historical Figure: An important person from the past.
8. Independence: When a country becomes free from another country.
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18. Globalization: When things or ideas spread around the world.
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22. Q: What are some major historical events in the 20th century that had global impact?

A: Some major events in the 20th century with global

Lesson 29. Volunteering and Social Issues

New Words and Definitions:

1. Volunteering: Helping others without getting paid.
2. Social Issues: Problems that affect many people in society.
3. Community Service: Work done to help others in your area.
4. Non-profit: An organization that doesn't try to make money, but helps others.
5. Charity: Giving help or money to those in need.
6. Philanthropy: Giving money or help to make life better for others.
7. Advocate: A person who supports or speaks for a cause or group.
8. Fundraise: To collect money for a cause.
9. Awareness: Knowing about a topic or problem.
10. Poverty: The state of having very little money or goods.
11. Homelessness: The state of having no home.
12. Inequality: When things are not equal or fair.
13. Discrimination: Treating some people unfairly because of their race, gender, etc.
14. Racism: Treating people badly because of their race.
15. Gender Equality: When men and women are treated the same.
16. Climate Change: Changes in the world's weather patterns.
17. Sustainability: Using resources in ways that don't harm the future.
18. Human Rights: Basic rights that every person should have.
19. Animal Welfare: Making sure animals are treated well.
20. Healthcare: Services that take care of people's health.
21. Education: Learning and training.
22. Unemployment: When people don't have jobs.
23. Immigration: Moving to a new country to live.
24. Activism: Working hard to make changes in society.
25. Volunteer: A person who helps others without getting paid.

Questions and Answers:

1. Q: Have you ever volunteered for a cause? Can you talk about the experience?

A: Yes, I have volunteered at a local food bank. It was a rewarding experience as I got to help those in need and learn about the issues of food insecurity in my community.

2. Q: Why is volunteering important?

A: Volunteering is important because it allows individuals to contribute to their community, support causes they believe in, and make a positive difference. It also promotes personal growth and understanding of social issues.

3. Q: What is a social issue that you feel strongly about?

A: I feel strongly about education inequality. Everyone should have the right to quality education regardless of their socioeconomic status.

4. Q: How can we raise awareness about social issues in our community?

A: We can raise awareness about social issues by organizing informative events, creating and sharing educational content, advocating for policies, and encouraging conversations about these issues.

5. Q: What is the role of non-profit organizations in addressing social issues?

A: Non-profit organizations play a crucial role in addressing social issues by providing services, advocating for policy changes, raising public awareness, and mobilizing resources to support those in need.

6. Q: How can volunteering benefit the volunteer?

A: Volunteering can benefit the volunteer by providing a sense of purpose, enhancing personal skills, expanding social connections, and offering valuable experiences and insights about different societal aspects.

7. Q: Can you talk about a social issue that is prevalent in Azerbaijan?

A: A prevalent social issue in Azerbaijan is the internally displaced persons due to conflicts. The government and various organizations are working to provide support, but it's a complex issue requiring long-term solutions.

8. Q: What is the role of philanthropy in society?

A: Philanthropy plays a significant role in society by supporting initiatives that address societal issues, fostering innovation and research, and contributing to the well-being of individuals and communities.

9. Q: What steps can we take to address gender inequality?

A: Steps to address gender inequality include promoting education and awareness about the issue, advocating for equal rights and opportunities, implementing policies that ensure gender parity, and challenging discriminatory attitudes and behaviors.

10. Q: How can individuals contribute to addressing climate change?

A: Individuals can contribute to addressing climate change by adopting sustainable practices, such as reducing waste, using renewable energy, supporting sustainable businesses, and advocating for environmental policies.

11. Q: How does volunteering support community development?

A: Volunteering supports community development by fostering social cohesion, enhancing local services, promoting civic engagement, and contributing to the overall well-being of the community.

12. Q: Can you talk about a time when you advocated for a social issue?

A: Yes, I have advocated for educational equality by participating in awareness campaigns, supporting initiatives that provide educational resources to underserved communities, and voicing my support for relevant policies.

13. Q: How can we address poverty in our society?

A: Addressing poverty in our society requires a comprehensive approach, including promoting access to quality education and jobs, ensuring social protection, advocating for fair wages, and supporting economic development initiatives.

14. Q: What is a significant social issue in the world today, and how can we address it?

A: A significant social issue today is climate change. We can address it by reducing greenhouse gas emissions, transitioning to renewable energy, adopting sustainable practices, and advocating for environmental policies.

15. Q: How does volunteering for a cause relate to citizenship?

A: Volunteering for a cause is an expression of active citizenship. It demonstrates responsibility towards the community and contributes to the common good by addressing societal issues and needs.

16. Q: What social issue do you think needs more attention in the media?

A: I believe mental health needs more attention in the media. Despite its significant impact, it is often overlooked or stigmatized, hindering people from seeking help and understanding the importance of mental health.

17. Q: How can we promote volunteerism among youth?

A: We can promote volunteerism among youth by raising awareness about the benefits and impacts of volunteering, providing diverse volunteering opportunities, recognizing and appreciating their contributions, and integrating volunteering into educational curriculums.

18. Q: What does the term 'social justice' mean to you?

A: To me, social justice means a society where everyone has equal access to opportunities, rights, resources, and is treated with fairness and respect, regardless of their identity, background, or circumstances. It's a society that actively addresses discrimination, inequalities, and injustices, ensuring that everyone can lead a fulfilling life with dignity.

19. Q: How can we use social media to address social issues?

A: Social media can be used to address social issues by spreading awareness, promoting advocacy and action, sharing stories and experiences, fundraising for causes, and creating a platform for dialogue and discussion about these issues.

20. Q: What is the role of governments in addressing social issues?

A: The role of governments in addressing social issues is crucial. They are responsible for implementing policies and regulations that address these issues, providing social services, promoting social justice and equality, and allocating resources towards societal development and well-being.

Lesson 30. Globalization and Multiculturalism

New Words and Definitions:

1. Globalization - The process by which businesses or other organizations develop international influence or start operating on an international scale.
2. Multiculturalism - The presence of, or support for the presence of, several distinct cultural or ethnic groups within a society.
3. Culture - The ideas, customs, and social behavior of a particular people or society.
4. Diversity - The state of being diverse; variety.
5. Ethnicity - The fact or state of belonging to a social group that has a common national or cultural tradition.
6. International - Existing, occurring, or carried on between nations.
7. Trade - The action of buying and selling goods and services.
8. Customs - The official department that administers and collects the duties levied by a government on imported goods.
9. Economy - The state of a country or region in terms of the production and consumption of goods and services and the supply of money.
10. Immigration - The action of coming to live permanently in a foreign country.
11. Influence - The capacity to have an effect on the character, development, or behavior of someone or something, or the effect itself.
12. Technology - The application of scientific knowledge for practical purposes.
13. Interconnected - Linking or connecting several parts together.
14. Outsourcing - Obtain (goods or a service) by contract from an outside supplier.
15. Export - Send (goods or services) to another country for sale.
16. Import - Bring (goods or services) into a country from abroad for sale.
17. Digital Era - The time period starting in the 1980s and characterized by a rapid shift from traditional industry that the Industrial Revolution brought through industrialization, to an economy based on information technology.
18. Multinational - A company operating in several countries.
19. E-commerce - Commercial transactions conducted electronically on the Internet.
20. Culture shock - The feeling of disorientation experienced by someone when they are suddenly subjected to an unfamiliar culture, way of life, or set of attitudes.

Questions and Answers:

1. Q: What is globalization?

A: Globalization is the process by which businesses or organizations develop international influence or operate on an international scale, often driven by trade and investment.

2. Q: How has globalization impacted our society?

A: Globalization has led to increased interconnectivity and interdependence among countries. It has influenced economic growth, cultural exchange, and information sharing but also resulted in concerns like economic disparity and cultural homogenization.

3. Q: What does multiculturalism mean to you?

A: Multiculturalism to me means the coexistence and mutual respect of multiple cultural or ethnic groups within a society. It celebrates diversity and encourages understanding and inclusivity.

4. Q: Have you ever experienced culture shock? Can you describe the experience?

A: Yes, I experienced culture shock when I first arrived in the United States for my studies. The norms, behaviors, and daily routines were very different from what I was used to, which initially made me feel overwhelmed and disoriented.

5. Q: How has technology contributed to globalization?

A: Technology has significantly contributed to globalization by enabling faster, easier, and cheaper communication, transportation, and transaction. It has facilitated the exchange of information and ideas, international trade, and cultural integration across borders.

6. Q: How has multiculturalism enriched your personal life?

A: Multiculturalism has enriched my personal life by exposing me to diverse cultures, perspectives, and experiences. It has broadened my understanding of the world and enhanced my interpersonal skills and cultural sensitivity.

7. Q: What are some negative impacts of globalization?

A: Some negative impacts of globalization include economic disparity, job insecurity due to outsourcing, cultural homogenization, and environmental degradation.

8. Q: How do you think we can promote multicultural understanding and respect?

A: We can promote multicultural understanding and respect by encouraging cultural exchange and education, fostering intercultural dialogue and collaboration, and advocating for inclusivity and equality.

9. Q: How does globalization affect the economy?

A: Globalization affects the economy by influencing trade, investment, and competition. It can foster economic growth and development but also lead to economic disparity and volatility.

10. Q: What is your experience with multiculturalism in the university?

A: At the university, I have classmates and professors from diverse cultural backgrounds. We often share our cultures and perspectives, which makes the learning environment vibrant and enriching.

11. Q: How does the digital era influence globalization?

A: The digital era greatly influences globalization by enabling instant communication, digital transactions, and information sharing across borders. It facilitates global collaboration and innovation but also raises issues like digital divide and data security.

12. Q: What is the impact of multinational companies on local economies?

A: Multinational companies can boost local economies by providing jobs, fostering technological transfer, and contributing to tax revenue. However, they may also lead to competition with local businesses, economic dependency, and income inequality.

13. Q: Can you give an example of a globalized product or service?

A: An example of a globalized product is the iPhone. Designed by Apple in the U.S., it incorporates components manufactured in different countries and is sold worldwide.

14. Q: What are the implications of e-commerce on globalization?

A: E-commerce has facilitated global trade by enabling businesses to reach customers worldwide, reducing transaction costs, and promoting competition. However, it also raises issues like tax evasion, data security, and digital divide.

15. Q: How do you think globalization influences cultural identities?

A: Globalization can influence cultural identities by introducing new ideas, norms, and practices. While it can lead to cultural exchange and hybridization, it may also result in cultural homogenization and loss of cultural uniqueness.

16. Q: Can you discuss the role of immigration in multicultural societies?

A: Immigration plays a significant role in multicultural societies by contributing to cultural diversity and demographic growth. Immigrants bring their cultural heritage, skills, and perspectives, enriching the host societies culturally, economically, and socially.

17. Q: What's the impact of outsourcing on the global economy?

A: Outsourcing can lower production costs, enhance efficiency, and promote international trade. However, it can also lead to job loss in high-cost countries, exploitation of workers in low-cost countries, and economic instability.

18. Q: How does globalization affect environmental sustainability?

A: Globalization can contribute to environmental degradation by promoting resource-intensive production, overconsumption, and waste. However, it can also foster global cooperation and innovation for environmental sustainability.

19. Q: How does multiculturalism impact education?

A: Multiculturalism can enrich education by introducing diverse perspectives, fostering cultural awareness and understanding, and promoting inclusive learning. However, it also poses challenges like linguistic barriers and cultural misunderstandings.

20. Q: How does globalization influence our daily lives?

A: Globalization influences our daily lives in many ways. It affects the goods we buy, the media we consume, and the jobs we have. It also exposes us to diverse cultures, ideas, and issues, shaping our perceptions and behaviors.

Lesson 31: Art and Creativity

New Words and Phrases:

1. Art - The expression or application of human creative skill and imagination.
2. Creativity - The use of imagination or original ideas to create something.
3. Self-expression - The expression of one's feelings, thoughts, or ideas.
4. Painting - The process or art of using paint, in a picture, as a protective coating, or as decoration.
5. Sculpture - The art of making two- or three-dimensional representative or abstract forms, by carving stone or wood or by casting metal or plaster.
6. Photography - The art or practice of taking and processing photographs.
7. Literature - Written works, especially those considered of superior or lasting artistic merit.
8. Dance - Move rhythmically to music, typically following a set sequence of steps.
9. Theatre - A place where plays and other dramatic performances are presented; the world of actors, theatrical companies, etc.
10. Music - Vocal or instrumental sounds (or both) combined in such a way as to produce beauty of form, harmony, and expression of emotion.

Questions and Answers:

1. Q: What kind of art forms do you like most?
A: I mostly enjoy visual arts, particularly painting and sculpture.
2. Q: Can you name a famous artist you admire? Why do you admire them?
A: I admire Vincent Van Gogh. His passion for art and unique style is truly inspiring.
3. Q: Do you engage in any creative activities?
A: Yes, I love to sketch and paint in my free time.
4. Q: Do you think creativity is a skill that can be developed?
A: Absolutely, with practice and patience, anyone can enhance their creativity.

5. Q: Have you ever tried creating a piece of art? How was your experience?

A: Yes, I once tried to create a piece of abstract art. It was a challenging but fun experience.

6. Q: What role does creativity play in your life?

A: Creativity helps me see things from different perspectives and come up with innovative solutions.

7. Q: Do you think modern art is as impactful as classical art?

A: Both have their own unique impacts and appeal to different audiences.

8. Q: Who is your favorite local artist?

A: My favorite local artist is Togrul Narimanbekov. His use of color is impressive.

9. Q: Do you think art education should be a compulsory part of school curriculum?

A: Yes, I believe art education encourages creativity and holistic development in students.

10. Q: How can art influence society?

A: Art can influence society by raising awareness about social issues and provoking thought and discussion.

11. Q: Can you describe a piece of art that you find memorable?

A: The Starry Night by Van Gogh is quite memorable. Its swirls of color and light create a dreamlike effect.

12. Q: How do you interpret art?

A: Art is subjective. My interpretation often depends on my personal experiences and emotions at the time.

13. Q: What is your opinion on street performances?

A: I think street performances are a vibrant part of city life and they make art accessible to everyone.

14. Q: What do you think is the role of art in preserving culture and history?

A: Art plays a crucial role in preserving culture and history by capturing and conveying stories, traditions, and events of the past.

15. Q: Would you like to visit an art fair? Why or why not?

A: Yes, I would love to. It's a wonderful opportunity to see a variety of artwork and perhaps discover new artists.

16. Q: How does creativity contribute to problem-solving?

A: Creativity encourages us to look at problems from different angles and come up with out-of-the-box solutions.

17. Q: Do you think digital art is as valuable as traditional art?

A: Both digital and traditional art have their own merits. The value depends on the creativity and skill of the artist.

18. Q: Have you ever tried to learn an art form? What was it?

A: Yes, I tried to learn watercolor painting. It was challenging but very enjoyable.

19. Q: Do you enjoy visiting art exhibitions? Why or why not?

A: Yes, I do. It's fascinating to see the diversity and depth of the artists' work.

20. Q: Do you think art and creativity are essential for human progress? Why?

A: Yes, I believe art and creativity drive innovation and help us to understand and express our human experience.

Lesson 32: Science and Discovery

New Words and Definitions:

1. Observation: The process of watching someone or something carefully in order to gain information.
2. Hypothesis: An idea or theory that is not proven but leads to further study or discussion.
3. Experiment: A scientific procedure undertaken to make a discovery, test a hypothesis, or demonstrate a known fact.
4. Data: Information collected for analysis or reference.
5. Conclusion: A judgment or decision reached after considering the facts and data.
6. Discovery: The act of finding or learning something for the first time.
7. Invention: The creation of something new, often a device or process, resulting from study and experimentation.
8. Theory: A set of principles on which the practice of an activity is based.
9. Research: The systematic study of materials and sources to establish facts and reach new conclusions.
10. Innovation: The process of making changes in something established, especially by introducing new methods or ideas.

Questions and Sample Answers:

1. Q: Can you name a scientific discovery that has significantly impacted society?
A: The discovery of penicillin has greatly impacted society as it was the first antibiotic, revolutionizing medicine.
2. Q: How does science contribute to our daily lives?
A: Science contributes to our daily lives in many ways, from the technology we use to the medicine we take and the food we eat.
3. Q: Do you enjoy learning about science? Why or why not?
A: Yes, I enjoy learning about science because it helps me understand how the world works.

4. Q: Can you explain the scientific method?

A: The scientific method involves making an observation, forming a hypothesis, conducting an experiment to test the hypothesis, analyzing the data, and drawing a conclusion.

5. Q: How important do you think it is for schools to teach science?

A: It is crucial for schools to teach science because it encourages critical thinking and helps students understand the world around them.

6. Q: What do you think about the role of science in solving global problems like climate change?

A: Science plays a critical role in solving global problems like climate change by providing data and innovations that can guide policy and actions.

7. Q: What scientific fact fascinates you the most?

A: The fact that the universe is constantly expanding fascinates me the most.

8. Q: Can you name a scientist you admire? Why do you admire them?

A: I admire Marie Curie. She was a pioneer in radioactivity research and was the first woman to win a Nobel Prize.

9. Q: Do you think scientific discovery is always beneficial?

A: Scientific discoveries have the potential to be greatly beneficial, but they can also be misused or have unintended consequences.

10. Q: How have scientific discoveries shaped the course of human history?

A: Scientific discoveries, such as the discovery of electricity or the invention of the internet, have drastically changed the way we live and interact.

11. Q: What role does curiosity play in science?

A: Curiosity is essential in science as it drives scientists to ask questions and seek answers, leading to new discoveries and advancements.

12. Q: What is the difference between a theory and a hypothesis in science?

A: A hypothesis is an untested prediction or explanation, while a theory is an explanation supported by substantial evidence and accepted by the scientific community.

13. Q: Can you name an invention that has significantly improved our lives?

A: The invention of the internet has significantly improved our lives by enabling instant communication, access to vast amounts of information, and a multitude of other conveniences.

14. Q: How does science help in developing technology?

A: Science provides the foundational knowledge and principles upon which technology is developed. Scientific research often leads to technological advancements.

15. Q: Why is it important for scientific studies to be repeatable?

A: It's important for scientific studies to be repeatable to verify the results. This ensures the accuracy of the findings and maintains the integrity of science.

16. Q: What is an example of scientific innovation that has influenced society?

A: The development of vaccines is an example of a scientific innovation that has greatly influenced society by preventing serious illnesses.

17. Q: Can you describe a time when you used scientific thinking in everyday life?

A: When I cook, I often use scientific thinking. For example, I make observations, form hypotheses about what will happen if I change ingredients, and then draw conclusions based on the results.

18. Q: Why is data important in science?

A: Data is important in science because it provides evidence to support or refute hypotheses and theories. It helps scientists make accurate conclusions.

19. Q: What do you think the future of science will look like?

A: The future of science will likely involve more advancements in technology, further exploration of space, and hopefully solutions to global challenges like climate change.

20. Q: What's your opinion on the importance of science in decision-making on societal issues?

A: I believe science is crucial in decision-making on societal issues. Scientific data can provide a basis for informed decisions and help predict the potential outcomes of different actions.

Lesson 33: Personal Achievements and Goals

New Words and Definitions:

1. Achievement - Something done successfully by using effort, skill, or courage.
2. Goal - An aim or desired result.
3. Ambition - A strong desire to do or achieve something.
4. Milestone - A significant stage or event in the development of something.
5. Success - The accomplishment of an aim or purpose.
6. Effort - Hard work; the use of a lot of mental or physical energy to do something.
7. Accomplish - To finish or complete something successfully.
8. Objective - A thing aimed at or sought; a goal.
9. Fulfillment - The achievement of something desired, promised, or predicted.
10. Persistence - The fact of continuing in an opinion or course of action in spite of difficulty or opposition.

Questions and Sample Answers:

1. Q: What's an achievement you are proud of?
A: I'm proud of the time when I won a local chess competition.
2. Q: What are your personal goals for the next year?
A: One of my goals for the next year is to improve my English speaking skills.
3. Q: How do you plan to achieve your goals?
A: I plan to take an English course and practice speaking English every day.
4. Q: What is your biggest ambition in life?
A: My biggest ambition in life is to become a successful entrepreneur.
5. Q: Can you share a milestone you've recently reached?
A: I recently reached a milestone in my studies by passing all my exams with high grades.

6. Q: How do you define success?

A: I define success as reaching your personal goals and feeling fulfilled and happy with your life.

7. Q: Have you ever accomplished something you initially thought you couldn't?

A: Yes, I initially thought I couldn't run a marathon, but with persistence and training, I accomplished it.

8. Q: What's an objective you are working towards right now?

A: I'm currently working towards the objective of getting a promotion at my job.

9. Q: How did you feel when you fulfilled your goal?

A: When I fulfilled my goal, I felt a great sense of accomplishment and pride.

10. Q: Can you give an example of a time when you had to be persistent to achieve something?

A: I had to be persistent when I was learning to play the guitar. It was difficult at first, but I kept practicing and eventually I was able to play full songs.

11. Q: How do you handle failure when trying to achieve your goals?

A: I see failure as an opportunity to learn and improve. It can be disheartening, but I try not to let it discourage me.

12. Q: Can you describe an achievement that required a lot of effort and patience?

A: Completing my university degree was an achievement that required a lot of effort and patience. It was a long journey, but I'm glad I stuck with it.

13. Q: Do you think it's important to set personal goals? Why or why not?

A: I think it's important to set personal goals because they give you a direction and purpose in life.

14. Q: What are some steps you've taken to accomplish your current objectives?

A: To accomplish my current objectives, I've created a detailed plan, set a timeline, and regularly check my progress.

15. Q: How do you celebrate your achievements?

A: I celebrate my achievements by taking some time to relax and enjoy the moment. Sometimes I also treat myself to something special.

16. Q: Do you think everyone has the potential to be successful? Why or why not?

A: Yes, I believe everyone has the potential to be successful in their own way. Success is subjective and everyone can define it in their own terms.

17. Q: How does achieving a goal make you feel?

A: Achieving a goal makes me feel accomplished and gives me a sense of satisfaction. It motivates me to continue working towards my other goals.

18. Q: Can you describe a time when you helped someone else achieve their goal?

A: I once tutored a friend who was struggling with a subject at school. With my help, she was able to improve her grades and pass the course.

19. Q: What's a goal that you haven't achieved yet, but are still working on?

A: I'm still working on my goal of learning a third language. It's challenging, but I'm making progress.

20. Q: How do you stay motivated to achieve your goals?

A: I stay motivated by reminding myself of why I set the goal in the first place and picturing how great it will feel once I achieve it.

Lesson34. Etiquette and Manners

New Words and Definitions:

1. Etiquette - the customary code of polite behavior in society or among members of a particular profession or group.
2. Manners - polite or well-bred social behavior.
3. Courtesy - the showing of politeness in one's attitude and behavior toward others.
4. Gesture - a movement of part of the body, especially a hand or the head, to express an idea or meaning.
5. Custom - a traditional and widely accepted way of behaving or doing something that is specific to a particular society, place, or time.
6. Norm - something that is usual, typical, or standard.
7. Polite - having or showing behavior that is respectful and considerate of other people.
8. Respect - a feeling of deep admiration for someone or something elicited by their abilities, qualities, or achievements.
9. Tradition - the transmission of customs or beliefs from generation to generation.
10. Interact - act in such a way as to have an effect on another.

Questions and Possible Answers:

1. Q: What does "etiquette" mean to you?

A: Etiquette means behaving politely and respectfully in social situations, according to cultural norms and standards.

2. Q: Can you give an example of good manners?

A: A good example of manners is saying "please" and "thank you" when asking for and receiving help or services.

3. Q: Why is it important to show courtesy to others?

A: Showing courtesy to others is important because it demonstrates respect and consideration for their feelings and dignity.

4. Q: How do etiquette and manners differ between cultures?

A: Etiquette and manners can vary greatly between cultures. For example, in some cultures, it's polite to burp after a meal, while in others, this would be considered rude.

5. Q: Can you give an example of a gesture that is considered polite in one culture but may be considered impolite in another?

A: In many Western cultures, making eye contact when speaking to someone is considered polite. However, in some Asian cultures, direct eye contact can be seen as confrontational or disrespectful.

6. Q: How would you explain the concept of "personal space" in terms of etiquette?

A: Personal space is the distance or boundary that people feel comfortable with when interacting with others. Respecting someone's personal space is an important aspect of etiquette.

7. Q: Can you share an example of a tradition or custom in your culture that involves specific etiquette or manners?

A: In my culture, it's a tradition to stand up when an elder enters the room as a sign of respect.

8. Q: Why is it important to learn about etiquette and manners when traveling to a new country?

A: It's important to learn about etiquette and manners when traveling to avoid offending locals and to show respect for their customs and traditions.

9. Q: What is one etiquette rule that you think is universal?

A: One universal etiquette rule is treating others the way you would like to be treated.

10. Q: How do you feel when someone shows good manners towards you?

A: When someone shows good manners towards me, I feel respected and valued.

11. Q: Can you mention an etiquette rule that you find unnecessary or outdated?

A: One etiquette rule that I find unnecessary is the rule about not wearing white after Labor Day. It's a fashion rule that has become quite outdated.

12. Q: How do you think technology has affected our manners and etiquette?

A: Technology has created new forms of communication where traditional manners and etiquette might not always apply. For instance, people may feel it's okay to interrupt a face-to-face conversation to respond to a text message, which can be considered impolite.

13. Q: What's your opinion about table manners? Are they important?

A: I believe table manners are important. They show respect for the people you're dining with and for the food you're eating.

14. Q: Can manners and etiquette change? If so, how?

A: Yes, manners and etiquette can change. They evolve over time as societal norms and values shift. What was once considered impolite may now be acceptable, and vice versa.

15. Q: Is it important to teach children about manners and etiquette? Why or why not?

A: Yes, it is important to teach children about manners and etiquette. It helps them learn respect for others and how to behave in social situations.

16. Q: How would you react if someone doesn't follow common etiquette around you?

A: If someone doesn't follow common etiquette around me, I would try to remain polite and understanding. Everyone comes from different backgrounds and might not be aware of certain etiquette rules.

17. Q: How does the etiquette in professional settings differ from that in personal settings?

A: Professional etiquette often involves more formal rules and expectations, like dressing appropriately, addressing colleagues respectfully, and maintaining a professional demeanor. Personal etiquette can be more relaxed and dependent on the specific relationship or context.

18. Q: How do cultural norms influence manners and etiquette?

A: Cultural norms play a big role in shaping manners and etiquette. They determine what behaviors are considered polite or impolite, and these norms can vary greatly between different cultures.

19. Q: Can you think of an example when understanding another culture's etiquette was beneficial to you?

A: Yes, understanding the local etiquette was very helpful when I traveled to Japan. Knowing about certain customs, like bowing to greet people and not tipping at restaurants, helped me interact more respectfully with the locals.

20. Q: Do you believe there should be global etiquette standards? Why or why not?

A: That's a difficult question. While having global etiquette standards might make interactions easier across different cultures, it could also lead to a loss of cultural diversity and uniqueness.

Lesson 35. Reflection and Progress

New Words and Definitions:

1. Reflect: To think deeply or carefully about something.
2. Progress: Forward or onward movement towards a destination.
3. Achievement: A thing done successfully with effort, skill, or courage.
4. Goal: The object of a person's ambition or effort; an aim or desired result.
5. Future: The time or a period of time following the moment of speaking or writing; time regarded as still to come.
6. Improve: Make or become better.
7. Motivation: The reason or reasons one has for acting or behaving in a particular way.
8. Challenge: A task or situation that tests someone's abilities.
9. Success: The accomplishment of an aim or purpose.
10. Determination: Firmness of purpose.

Questions and Possible Answers:

1. Q: How do you feel about the progress you've made in your English learning?
A: I feel very positive about my progress. I think I've improved a lot.
2. Q: What is one achievement in your language learning that you are proud of?
A: I am proud of my improved pronunciation. It was a challenge at first, but I worked hard on it.
3. Q: What is one area you still want to improve in?
A: I still want to improve my vocabulary. There are so many words I want to learn.
4. Q: How do you keep yourself motivated in your language learning journey?
A: I keep myself motivated by setting small, achievable goals. I also remind myself of the benefits of knowing a second language.

5. Q: How do you plan to continue your language learning in the future?

A: I plan to continue taking English classes and practicing speaking as much as possible. I will also continue to read in English.

6. Q: What was the most challenging part of learning English for you?

A: The most challenging part was understanding the different tenses in English. It took a while to get used to them.

7. Q: How did you overcome that challenge?

A: I overcame the challenge by practicing a lot and asking for help when I didn't understand something.

8. Q: What advice would you give to someone who is just starting to learn English?

A: I would tell them to be patient and to practice as much as they can. It's also important to not be afraid of making mistakes.

9. Q: How has learning English affected your life?

A: Learning English has opened up many opportunities for me. I can communicate with more people and understand more about the world.

10. Q: What is your ultimate goal in learning English?

A: My ultimate goal is to be fluent in English. I want to be able to use it confidently in any situation.

11. Q: What's the most useful technique you've discovered for learning English?

A: The most useful technique for me has been to immerse myself in the language as much as possible. That means listening to English music, watching English movies, and reading English books.

12. Q: How have your teachers helped you in your English learning journey?

A: My teachers have been very supportive. They always explain things clearly, give me useful feedback, and encourage me to do my best.

13. Q: Have you ever used English outside of the classroom? How did it go?

A: Yes, I've used English while travelling. It was a bit challenging, but it was also a great way to practice.

14. Q: Do you ever dream in English? What does it feel like?

A: Sometimes I do dream in English. It feels very strange, but it's also kind of exciting because it shows that I'm really getting the language.

15. Q: How do you feel when you understand something in English that you couldn't before?

A: When I understand something in English that I couldn't before, I feel very proud and motivated to keep learning.

16. Q: What are some English words or phrases that you particularly like?

A: I particularly like the phrase "Never give up". It's simple, but it reminds me to keep trying, no matter what.

17. Q: What resources do you use to study English outside of class?

A: I use English learning apps, watch English YouTube videos, and read English newspapers online to study outside of class.

18. Q: How do you tackle the challenge of English pronunciation?

A: I try to listen to a lot of English music and watch English movies to improve my pronunciation. It's challenging, but I'm getting better.

19. Q: What are your language learning goals for the next term?

A: My goal for the next term is to improve my speaking skills. I want to be more fluent and confident in speaking English.

20. Q: How do you plan to celebrate when you reach your English learning goals?

A: I plan to celebrate by treating myself to a nice meal or a small trip. It's important to celebrate these milestones.